

Reimagine

User Guide

A plain-English guide to using Reimagine to build your career strategy.

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How to read this guide

You can read it front to back, or jump to the chapter that matches where you are.

If you have never opened the tool, start with **Chapters 1–3**. They explain what Reimagine is, what to have ready, and the single most important idea in the whole guide: the quality of your inputs sets the ceiling on the quality of your outputs.

If you are inside the tool right now and want help with a specific phase, jump to that phase's chapter. Each one has the same shape: what this phase does, what to expect on screen, what good looks like, and how to refine the result before moving on.

If something is not working the way you expect, check **Chapter 14: FAQ and Troubleshooting**.

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A note on how Reimagine works with you

Reimagine is not a one-shot generator. After every output, you have the option to tell it what to adjust, then regenerate. You will see this throughout the journey. The tool is designed to be used iteratively, not perfectly the first time. Chapter 12 covers this in detail, and every phase chapter points back to it.

*Reimagine is built by Career Club. Founder and product owner: Bob Goodwin, bob@career.club.
Reimagine is in active beta. If something feels off, that feedback shapes what gets built next.*

Quick Start Guide

(Bridge Story structure updated 2026-05-19; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)

A short summary of the full guide.

What Reimagine is

A web-based career strategy tool for professionals navigating a transition. You bring your inputs. Reimagine produces a clear professional identity, a wider view of options, a story you can tell, a target company list with personalized outreach, refreshed LinkedIn and resume copy, and a playbook for every conversation ahead. Built on Bob Goodwin's *Making Your Own Weather* methodology.

What you need

- Your resume (any format)
- An assessment from the last three years (Affintus, CliftonStrengths, MBTI, DiSC, Hogan, etc.). Affintus is free and takes 15 minutes
- About 20 to 30 minutes for the intake. The full journey takes longer than one sitting; pace yourself across multiple sessions

The single most important idea

The quality of your inputs determines how much Reimagine can help you. The first 20 minutes of the journey are where the leverage is: your resume, your assessment, your values, your passions, four short reputation prompts, and a few formative experiences from Your Story. Put your best foot forward at the intake and Reimagine will do the same for you in everything that follows.

A few specifics: take an assessment if you do not have one (the difference is significant). When you describe your passions, do not filter for what feels professionally relevant. The unexpected combinations are what Reimagine looks for. For Your Story, the formative experiences that shaped how you work often surface anchors no other input captures, so share what feels relevant even if it does not read like resume material. For the reputation step, dig up old performance reviews, LinkedIn recommendations, and 360 feedback before you start.

The journey, at a glance

- **Orientation.** Your inputs. The only phase where you do the work.
- **Know Your Value.** Reimagine translates your accomplishments and synthesizes a personal brand.
- **Explore Options.** Pick a direction (Familiar Ground, Industry Insider, or Work That Matters) and Reimagine shows specific roles for it. Or paste a job description for a role you already have in hand.
- **The Focus Playbook.** Click any role and Reimagine builds a complete playbook for that one role: The Role, Bridge Story, Industry Background, Interview Prep, STAR Stories, Resume Refresh,

LinkedIn Remix, Go-to-Market, and Income Now. The Role generates immediately; the rest generate on demand, in that order. Save any playbook as a PDF, and re-explore other roles anytime.

Things worth knowing before you start

This is iterative. Every output has a "Does this feel right?" feedback box. Use it for factual corrections or stylistic tuning. Factual corrections persist across the whole session, so the same correction does not need to be made twice.

You can speak instead of type. Most input fields have a microphone button. Tap it and talk.

Reimagine Help is on every screen. Click the button in the bottom-right corner to ask a question about how Reimagine works.

Sign-in is by email. First visit, enter your email; a sign-in link arrives in your inbox. No password. Sign-in is what makes your work travel across devices.

You can come back. Once you choose one direction at the Your Focus step, Reimagine builds your story, target list, LinkedIn, and resume around it. You can later come back to Your Focus, choose a different option, and run that one through the journey too. You only need one new job, but you can explore as many options as you want.

Reimagine generates copy. You apply it. The LinkedIn Remix and Resume Refresh outputs are recommendations you take into your own LinkedIn profile and resume document. The tool does not modify those for you.

The destination is the Complete screen. When you finish, every output is gathered there as a working library. Copy any section, view any of them, download the one-page PDF or the full set of outputs as markdown. From there, the Add an Opportunity module is one click away for any specific role you want to pursue.

Where to start

Open **reimagine.career.club**. Click **Let's get started**. The first thing you see is the welcome screen. Read it, then click forward into the Orientation phase.

If anything along the way feels off, the full guide has a chapter for every phase, plus chapters on refining and regenerating, saving your work, an FAQ, a glossary, and a changelog.

1. What Reimagine Is

(Bridge Story structure updated 2026-05-19; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)

In one paragraph

Reimagine is a web-based career strategy tool for senior professionals in transition. You bring your resume, an assessment, a few honest answers about your values and reputation, and your sense of what you want next. Reimagine walks you through a structured journey that turns those inputs into a personal brand, a map of options, a story you can tell, a list of target companies, an outreach plan, and the materials you need to walk into conversations ready. It is built on the methodology in Bob Goodwin's book *Making Your Own Weather*.

Who it is for

Reimagine is built for professionals who have been in the work world for a while and are asking the question, *what do I want next, and how do I get there?* Most of our users are executives, VPs, directors, or seasoned individual contributors. Some are between roles, some are still employed and thinking ahead, and some are reinventing after a long run in one industry.

If that is the question you are sitting with, Reimagine is for you.

If you are looking for a job board, a resume rewrite by template, or a generic career quiz, this is not that.

What you will end up with

By the time you finish the journey, you will have:

- A clear statement of your **personal brand** and the value you bring, with proof points from your own track record.
- A **map of options** across three paths, narrowed down to the direction you choose to pursue.
- A **bridge story**. Your answer to "tell me about yourself". That connects who you are to where you are headed.
- A **target company list** with hiring decision-makers and personalized outreach you can send today.
- A **LinkedIn refresh**, a **resume refresh**, and a **playbook** of industry vocabulary, key people to follow, interview prep, and STAR stories.
- An optional **Income Now** plan if you need revenue while you search.
- A downloadable **one-page PDF** summarizing it all.

How long it takes

Plan for about 20 to 30 minutes for the intake (the questions Reimagine asks you), and then more time as you read each section, give feedback, and let it regenerate where you want adjustments. The tool generates each section in roughly one to two minutes. The full journey is meant to be paced across multiple sessions, not completed in one. Your work is saved automatically once you sign in (a one-time email link, no password). Pick it back up from any device.

How it actually works

Reimagine sends your inputs to Claude, a large language model from Anthropic, with carefully tuned instructions for each step. Claude returns the analysis. Reimagine formats it, presents it to you, and gives you a way to refine it.

You do not need to know any of that to use the tool. Two things are worth knowing:

- **What you put in shapes what comes out.** Chapter 3 explains why this is the most important idea in the whole guide.
- **You can always go back and update.** If you remember something later, or learn something new about yourself, or want to try a different direction, you can return to any earlier step, change your input, and regenerate from there. Chapter 12 explains how.

Your data and how it is stored

Once you sign in, Reimagine saves your work to a Career Club database keyed to your email. That is what makes your progress travel across devices. Your inputs travel to two places: Anthropic's Claude service (which generates each section of your strategy) and Career Club's own database (which holds your progress). No third parties beyond those.

Your inputs and outputs are not shared with anyone. There is no advertising, no marketing pipeline, no list of users sold or rented. If you decide to stop using Reimagine, your data can be removed on request.

What Reimagine will not do for you

It will not apply to jobs for you. It will not write your cover letters in bulk. It will not lie about your experience or invent accomplishments. It will not tell you what you want to hear if your resume tells a different story.

What it does instead is hold up a mirror, point at the patterns you may not see in yourself, and turn that into a strategy you can act on this week.

Next: Before You Begin →

2. Before You Begin

What to bring

You will get the most out of Reimagine if you have these three things ready before you start.

1. Your resume

Any format is fine: PDF, Word, or plain text. It does not have to be polished. Reimagine will work with whatever you give it. If you have not updated it in years, do not let that stop you. Part of what the tool does is find the value you may have undersold.

2. An assessment. Highly recommended

This is the input that does the most to turn a generic career analysis into one that actually sounds like you. Reimagine is greatly limited in its ability to generate real human insights about your unique value if it does not have one. Your resume tells the tool what you have done. An assessment tells it *how* you do it. How you make decisions, what energizes you, the environments where you do your best work. That second layer is where personalized insight comes from.

If you do not already have one, take **Affintus**. It is free, it takes about 15 minutes, and it gives Reimagine the data layer that makes everything downstream feel personal. The link to it is on the welcome screen and again on the Assessment input screen.

Reimagine accepts any of the major professional assessments:

- **Affintus** (free. Reimagine recommends this if you do not already have one)
- **CliftonStrengths** (formerly StrengthsFinder)
- **Myers-Briggs (MBTI)**
- **DiSC**
- **Hogan**
- **Predictive Index**
- **Enneagram**
- Any other professional assessment you have on hand

Keep it recent. We recommend assessments be no more than three years old. People change, and old data may not reflect how you operate today.

You can combine more than one. The Assessment screen has one upload slot, but you can also paste results into the text field. If you have two or three assessments you want Reimagine to consider, paste them sequentially into the text field with a simple divider line between each (for example, === CliftonStrengths === then the results, then === Hogan === then those results). Reimagine will read all of it.

If you decide to skip the assessment entirely, Reimagine will still work, but the recommendations will be more abstract and less personal. Chapter 3 explains why this matters.

3. About 20 to 30 minutes for the intake

That covers entering your information and getting your first set of results. The full journey takes longer because each phase asks you to read what was generated and decide whether to refine it. The journey is meant to be paced; you do not need to finish in one sitting.

Use a laptop, desktop, or tablet

Reimagine works best on a larger screen. If you are on a phone, rotate to landscape mode for a usable experience. Portrait phone view is currently limited because of how the sidebar navigation is built. The sidebar takes up most of the viewport on a narrow portrait screen, leaving very little room for the content.

A future release will add full responsive design for phones. For now, landscape mode on a phone is the workaround if a larger screen is not available. If you visit Reimagine on a portrait phone, a small banner at the top of the page will remind you and you can dismiss it for the session.

You can speak instead of type

Most of the text fields in Reimagine have a small microphone button next to them. It looks like this:

!Microphone button. A small white square with rounded corners and a gray microphone icon inside

Tap it and talk. Reimagine listens and writes what you say into the field. Tap it again to stop. While it is listening, the button turns red. Use it for your values, your passions, your reputation answers, and any feedback you give later when you refine a result. You can always just speak to Reimagine.

Sign-in by email

Reimagine signs you in with a magic link. No password to remember.

The sign-in screen is a two-step form. First you enter your email and click Continue. If Reimagine already has an account for that email, it sends you a sign-in link right away. If you are new, Reimagine asks for your first and last name, then sends the link. Either way, you check your inbox, click the link, and you are in.

Your session lasts 30 days, but the clock resets every time you use the tool. Active users essentially never see the sign-in screen again after their first visit. The session only expires if you go a full 30 days without opening Reimagine, in which case you sign in once and you are back where you left off.

The reason for sign-in is simple: your work syncs across devices automatically once you are signed in. Start on your laptop, finish on your phone. Pick up on a different computer at home. Your progress travels with you.

If you were using Reimagine before this update and already have work saved in your browser, a one-time prompt asks if you want to save your work across devices. Accept, and your existing progress uploads to your new account. Decline, and Reimagine keeps using browser-local storage exactly as it did before.

Your work is saved automatically

Reimagine saves your progress to your account as you go. As long as you are signed in, you can close the tab, switch devices, or come back next week, and your work will be where you left it.

There are two things worth knowing:

- **Your inputs travel only to Anthropic's Claude service** to generate each section of your strategy, plus to Career Club's own database to save your progress against your email. No other parties receive your information.
- **You can still export a snapshot.** If you want to download a copy of everything for your own records, the Results screen has a download button (Chapter 13).

How we protect your data

All connections to Reimagine use HTTPS. Sign-in is passwordless: the link in your email expires after 15 minutes and works only once. Your session is protected with secure cookies that pages cannot read. Your data is stored in an encrypted database. Inputs sent to Anthropic's Claude service for generation are governed by Anthropic's standard data handling.

Career Club is a small team and does not currently hold formal security certifications such as SOC 2. If you have specific security or compliance requirements before signing up, email bob@career.club.

If you want your account deleted, email bob@career.club. Your user record, your profile, your generated outputs, and your correction history will be permanently removed from the database within seven days.

A few things worth knowing before you start

This is iterative, not linear. After every result, you have the option to say "this is not quite right, here is what to adjust" and regenerate. Use it. Reimagine gets better with that feedback.

There are no wrong answers in the intake. When the tool asks about your values, your passions, or your reputation, it is not testing you. Give honest answers, not strategic ones. Strategic answers produce strategic-sounding output that does not feel like you.

You only need one new job. But you can explore as many options as you want. The journey eventually asks you to commit to one direction so the rest of the tool can build a focused plan around it. That does not mean you have to throw the other options away. Once you have walked through with one role in mind, you can come back and explore another in the same depth. Reimagine is designed to open your eyes to what is possible, not to corner you into one answer. The point is to choose the right next chapter with confidence, knowing you saw the field clearly.

Next: The Quality of Your Inputs →

3. The Quality of Your Inputs

This is the most important chapter in the guide. If you read only one chapter before starting, read this one.

The principle

Reimagine builds your career strategy on top of what you tell it about yourself during **Orientation**, the first phase of the journey. Everything that comes out, your personal brand, your options, your story, your target list, your outreach, your playbook, is built on what you provide there.

If your inputs are thin, the output will be thin in the same places. If your inputs are rich and honest, the output is sharp and personal. There is no shortcut around this. The rest of the tool is downstream of what you do in the first 20 minutes.

Put your best foot forward in the intake, and Reimagine will do the same for you in everything that follows.

The inputs

In the order Reimagine asks for them:

- **Location and work preference.** Where you live and how you want to work
- **Resume.** Your professional track record
- **LinkedIn.** How you present yourself publicly (optional)
- **Assessment.** How you are wired
- **Values, passions, and causes.** What you actually care about
- **Reputation.** What others say about you
- **Your Story.** The things that shaped you that a resume does not show (optional)
- **Skills.** The capabilities Reimagine pulls from your resume and LinkedIn for you to confirm

Each one feeds something specific later in the journey. Understanding that connection is the fastest way to know what good input looks like. Two of them, LinkedIn and Your Story, are optional, and Skills is drafted for you; the rest are where your time is best spent.

Why each input matters

Location and work preference

This shapes every option Reimagine generates and every company it recommends. If you are open to relocation, the range of role options Reimagine can map opens up. If you are remote-only in a specific country, the company list narrows accordingly.

Good input: specific country, optionally a city or metro, and a clear work arrangement. The tool offers fully remote, hybrid, on-site, open to relocation, and open to relocation with conditions.

What to watch for: if you select "open to relocation" but you are really only open to two specific cities, say so in a later refine step or list those cities in the City field. The more honest the constraint, the more useful the company list.

Resume

The resume is the source of every accomplishment Reimagine will translate into your value proposition. It is how the tool knows what you have actually done.

Good input: your most recent resume, even if you have not polished it. Bullet points with numbers are gold. Revenue you drove, money you saved, teams you built, problems you solved with measurable outcomes. If your resume is light on numbers, that is fine; Reimagine will flag where you should add quantification when it analyzes you.

Watch out for: a resume that lists job titles and responsibilities but not outcomes. Reimagine can work with that, but the resulting Value Proposition will be more abstract than you want. If you have time, spend a few minutes adding the numbers you remember before you upload.

You can always update it later. If you remember a major project after the fact, go back to the Resume step, replace the file or paste in updated text, and regenerate from Phase 1. Chapter 12 explains how.

LinkedIn

Optional, and worth a couple of minutes. Your LinkedIn holds material your resume does not: your About section (how you position yourself in public), recommendations from colleagues, skills others have endorsed, and what you engage with publicly. Adding it sharpens how Reimagine reads the way you present yourself and what others say about you.

It also lets Reimagine produce a true *refresh* of your LinkedIn later in the journey, pointed at your actual profile and what to change, instead of copy written from scratch.

Good input: export your profile as a PDF (the LinkedIn step shows you exactly how) or paste your About section and recommendations into the field. If you do not have a profile, skip it; the rest of the journey still works.

Assessment

This is the input that makes the biggest difference. Your resume tells Reimagine what you have done. Your assessment tells Reimagine *how* you do it. How you make decisions, what energizes you, the environments where you do your best work.

Without an assessment, Reimagine is greatly limited in its ability to generate real human insight about your unique value. Your output will lean on your track record alone, and that produces recommendations that feel more like a job-market summary than a personal strategy.

Take Affintus if you do not already have one. It is free, it takes 15 minutes, and it gives Reimagine the data layer that turns generic into personal. The link is on the welcome screen and on the Assessment input screen.

Good input: any professional assessment from the last three years. We recommend assessments be no older than that. People change, and old data may not reflect how you operate today. Affintus, CliftonStrengths, MBTI, DiSC, Hogan, PI, Enneagram, or anything else works. Upload the report, paste the results, or both.

You can use more than one. If you have two or three assessments and want Reimagine to consider all of them, paste their results sequentially into the text field with a simple divider line between each. For example:

```
``` === CliftonStrengths === Top 5: Strategic, Achiever, Learner, Maximizer, Input [full results]
=== Hogan === [full results] ```
```

Reimagine will read all of it. The dropdown lets you label only one type for now; that is a labeling limit, not a content limit.

**If you skip the assessment entirely,** Reimagine will warn you once and then proceed. The tool will still generate a strategy from your resume, values, and reputation. It will be useful. It will not be as personal as it could have been.

## Values, passions, and causes

These two fields are short, and they are the difference between a list of *plausible* options and a list of *right* options.

**Values** are your non-negotiables. The conditions under which you do your best work and feel most like yourself. Independence, family, justice, stability, faith, intellectual challenge, service, wealth creation, cooperation. Three to five is enough.

**Passions, interests, and causes** are what you read about for fun, volunteer your time for, or could talk about for 30 minutes with no preparation. Hobbies, industries that fascinate you, communities you belong to, causes close to your heart. Three to five is enough.

**Good input:** specific and honest. "Sustainability" is fine. "Sustainability, especially how cities adapt their infrastructure" is better. "Mentoring" is fine. "Mentoring first-generation college students through nonprofits in my city" is much better.

**A common slip:** filtering your answers for what feels professionally relevant. Try not to. The Explore Options phase later on looks for unexpected combinations between your professional life and the rest of you, and your full set of passions is what it needs. The youth sports coaching, the side project, the cause you donate to, the industry you read about for fun. Those are all worth including. Some of the most surprising connections in the whole experience come from inputs people almost left out.

## Reputation

This is one of the most valuable inputs you can give Reimagine. It is external data: what other people actually see in you, not what you see in yourself. Even one specific moment of professional feedback transforms what the tool can do with the rest of your inputs.

Reimagine asks four short questions. You can answer any combination of them, or skip and let the tool generate a hypothesis from your other data.

- **The Memory.** A specific moment when someone thanked you or praised you at work. What was the situation, and what did they say?
- **The Emergency Call.** If your former team had a critical problem right now, what kind of situation would they call you to handle?
- **The Two Words.** If your best former manager described your professional superpower in exactly two words, what would they be?
- **Additional Feedback.** Anything from performance reviews, LinkedIn recommendations, 360 feedback. Paste it in.

**Good input:** specific moments, not summaries. "Praised for being collaborative" is generic. "After the merger, the new CFO told me in front of the leadership team that I was the only one who got both sides talking to each other" is specific and useful.

**Worth a few minutes of digging before you start.** Sources to look through:

- Old performance reviews, especially the comments from your manager or skip-level
- LinkedIn recommendations you have received over the years
- Written 360 feedback or peer reviews if you have them
- Emails or notes from former bosses, colleagues, clients, or partners where they said something specific you remember
- Slack or chat messages where a teammate thanked you for something concrete

If you do not have anything in writing, sit with the four questions for a few minutes. A moment of professional praise usually surfaces when you give yourself the space. The more specific the moment, the more useful it is.

## Your Story

The things that shape who you are often do not show up on a resume: where you grew up, the role you played in your family, an identity you carry, a person who shaped you, a long-running commitment, or a season that changed you. This step is optional, and you share only what you are comfortable sharing. One thing or several.

It is also one of the quietly powerful inputs. A formative experience is often the most distinctive way to open your Bridge Story later, the thing that makes a listener remember you. When your inputs carry it, Reimagine builds from it; when they do not, it works from the rest.

**Good input:** a specific moment or thread, in your own words. Rough is fine. The microphone helps here; talking it through is usually easier than typing.

## Skills

Reimagine reads your resume and LinkedIn and drafts your skills for you, across five groups: technical and tools, systems and platforms, certifications, languages, and methodologies and frameworks. Your job is to check the list, add what is missing, and clear out anything that does not belong. A button lets

you re-extract if you update your resume or LinkedIn.

This list shapes how the rest of Reimagine reads you: which options fit, which keywords land, which company targets feel right. A minute of cleanup here pays off downstream.

## You can speak instead of type

Every text field that asks you to describe yourself. Values, passions, reputation, Your Story, and the refine boxes you will see later. Has a small microphone button next to it that looks like this:

!Microphone button. A small white square with rounded corners and a gray microphone icon inside

Tap it and talk. Reimagine listens and writes what you say into the field. Tap it again to stop, and the button turns red while it is listening so you know it is on. You can always just speak to Reimagine.

This matters most for the inputs that benefit from specific stories. The Reputation step in particular. Talking through a specific moment is usually easier than typing it, and the result tends to be richer.

## How your data is handled

Reimagine uses passwordless accounts. When you sign in, your email is used to send a magic-link sign-in code; we do not store passwords. Your inputs, the outputs Reimagine generates, and your profile data are saved to your Reimagine account so you can pick up where you left off on any device you sign in from. This information is stored on cloud infrastructure in the United States and encrypted at rest.

Reimagine sends your inputs to Anthropic's Claude service to generate each section of your strategy. Anthropic processes these requests under their own terms; Reimagine does not use your inputs to train any AI model.

You control your data. You can delete your account at any time using the Start Fresh option in the product or by writing to us at [info@career.club](mailto:info@career.club). Reimagine also collects anonymous behavioral analytics (which sections you visit, how long generations take) used to improve the product. To improve the coach and chat features, our team may also review those conversations on a de-identified basis (your name and email removed, so reviewers see the conversation but not who you are); we do not sell that content, use it to train AI models, or use it to contact you.

For the full details, see the Privacy Policy and the Terms of Service.

## You can always go back and update

Every input is editable. If you remember a key accomplishment after Phase 1, or you realize the assessment did not capture something important, or your work preference changes mid-journey, you can return to that input step, change it, and regenerate the analysis from there.

Chapter 12 covers exactly how to do this without losing the work you have already done downstream. The short version: Reimagine is built to be revisited. Treat your first pass as a draft.

## A short checklist before you start

Use this as a quick gut check before you click "Let's get started."

- ☐ My resume is current within the last few months and includes my most recent role.
- ☐ My resume has numbers attached to my biggest accomplishments where I can.
- ☐ I have at least one assessment from the last three years, or I am going to take Affintus before I begin.
- ☐ I am ready to share my real values and passions, including the ones that feel "off-topic."
- ☐ I have at least one specific moment of professional praise or feedback in mind for the Reputation step.
- ☐ Optional, worth it: my LinkedIn exported as a PDF, and a formative experience or two I am open to sharing in Your Story.

You do not need every line checked to start; the more you can, the sharper the result. Your Skills are drafted from your resume and LinkedIn automatically, so there is nothing to prepare there. Start when you are ready.

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*Next: Phase 0. Orientation →*



## 4. Phase 0. Orientation: Telling Reimagine About You

*(Bridge Story structure updated 2026-05-19; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)*

This is the only phase where you do the work. Everything that follows is generated for you. This chapter walks through each screen so you know what to expect and what good input looks like at each one.

If you have not read **Chapter 3: The Quality of Your Inputs** yet, do that first. This chapter assumes you have.

The Orientation phase has nine screens, in this order:

- Welcome
- Location & Work
- Your Resume
- Your LinkedIn (optional)
- Assessments
- Values, Passions & Causes
- Your Priorities & Non-Negotiables
- Reputation
- Your Story (optional)
- Your Skills

You can navigate them with the **Continue** and **Back** buttons at the bottom of each screen, or jump to any completed step using the sidebar on the left.

[screenshot: the left sidebar showing the seven phases with the Orientation phase expanded]

### Screen 1: Welcome

The welcome screen explains what Reimagine is, what to bring, and how the journey is structured. If this is your first visit, it also asks for your email so you can sign in.

Sign-in is a two-step form. Enter your email and click Continue. If Reimagine already has an account for that email, it sends you a sign-in link right away. If you are new, you will see a "Looks like this is your first time" screen with first and last name fields. Fill those in, click Send, and the link arrives in your inbox.

Click the link in either case and you are in. Your session lasts 30 days, refreshed each time you use the tool, so active users rarely see the sign-in screen again after the first visit.

If you have used Reimagine before and your session is still active in this browser, you skip straight past sign-in and land on your last step. If you are on a new device or your session has expired, you sign in again with the same email and your work appears.

Chapter 2 has more detail on sign-in and what to do if the link does not arrive.

## Screen 2: Location & Work

This shapes every option Reimagine generates and every company it identifies later in the journey.

**Country / Region.** The country you are based in or want to work in. Required. The field is an autocomplete dropdown: type the first few letters and a list of common countries appears. You can also type a country not on the list and it accepts free text.

**City or Metro.** Optional. If you are open to multiple cities, leave it blank. If you have a preferred metro, name it.

**Work Arrangement.** Required. Pick any combination of:

- Remote
- Hybrid
- On-site

If you are open to multiple arrangements, select multiple. If your situation is more specific (e.g., you would relocate only to two specific cities), pick your preferred arrangements here and clarify in the values or in a refine step later.

Click **Continue** when you are done.

## Screen 3: Your Resume

Your resume is the raw material for everything Reimagine builds with you next. This screen gives you two ways to provide it.

You do not need to polish or update your resume before you start. If yours is out of date, the builder rebuilds it with you (see Door 2).

### Door 1: Already have an up-to-date resume?

If your resume is current, this is the fast path: Reimagine uses it as-is.

**Upload.** Drag a file onto the upload area or click to browse. PDF, Word (.docx), and plain text all work.

**Paste.** If you would rather paste the text directly, use the text field below the upload area.

You can do both. The text field is the source of truth for what Reimagine reads, so if you want to edit something after uploading, edit it in the text field.

Once Reimagine has read the file, you will see a green checkmark and a character count. Click **Continue**.

### Door 2: Out of date, or don't have one?

If your resume is stale, thin, or missing, Reimagine builds one with you and gets you to a complete, sendable draft fast. You refine a resume that already exists rather than building up to one. Whatever you hand over is a jumpstart only: Reimagine rebuilds it fresh, so an old version you are not proud of never carries through.

Here is how the builder works:

- **Pick a starting point.** Give it whatever you already have:
  - **An old resume**, even years out of date (PDF, Word, or text). Reimagine reads it and rebuilds it clean.
  - **Your LinkedIn**, if you have no resume handy. Open your profile, click the three dots, choose Save to PDF, and upload that file. (Using your LinkedIn here also means the LinkedIn step later does not ask for it again.)
  - **A few basics**, if you have neither. You give companies, titles, and dates, and Reimagine drafts from those. Either way you are never staring at a blank page.
- **Get a complete draft right away.** If you upload LinkedIn, Reimagine reads your roles, dates, the accomplishments you already wrote, your skills, and your education, and writes a full first draft. If you start from scratch, you give the basics (companies, titles, dates, and optionally a few lines about your work) and Reimagine drafts from those. No long questionnaire first.
- **Edit it on the page.** The draft is your workspace, and everything on it is editable: the summary, each bullet, your skills, and your education. Your changes save as you go.
- **Sharpen it where you want to, all optional.** A bullet without a number shows an **add a number?** prompt that names how that kind of work is usually measured. **Say more about this role** opens a box to add anything that is missing, and can offer a few role-typical ideas to jog your memory. **Suggest more skills** finds skills your draft implies. None of this is required; the draft already works without it.

The draft is written to a broadly legible posture, the kind a wide range of recruiters read easily, in a clean single-column format. It is good enough to send today. Download it as a Word file, and the text flows into the rest of orientation exactly as an uploaded resume would.

The builder is a step you can return to. Your draft is saved to your account, so you can leave, come back, and add more whenever new details surface. When you do, Reimagine also offers to refresh your Personal Brand and the work that builds on it, so your sharper material reaches every downstream result. That refresh is always your choice, never automatic.

**A reminder from Chapter 3:** the more your resume includes specific outcomes. Money made, money saved, risk mitigated, with numbers attached. The better the output. If you have time, add a few numbers. If you do not, that is fine. Reimagine will flag where it would help and you can come back later.

## Screen 4: Your LinkedIn (optional)

This step is optional. Adding it sharpens what Reimagine knows about you in ways the resume alone cannot.

### Why bother

Your LinkedIn profile holds material your resume does not:

- **Your About section** is your own public self-positioning, often phrased differently than your resume. Reimagine reads it as a tone reference for the Bridge Story and as a starting baseline for the LinkedIn Remix later in the journey.
- **Recommendations** are direct quotes from colleagues. These count as reputational signal alongside what you enter on the Reputation screen.
- **Skills with endorsement counts** carry social proof. They show the competencies others have validated, the ones with public backing behind them.
- **Activity** (what you post, comment on, share) signals values and passions in a way you may not articulate yourself.

There is a second reason worth flagging. In Phase 5 (Get Ready), Reimagine generates a LinkedIn Remix: recommendations for your headline, your About section, and your experience entries. Without your current profile as input, the Remix is generated from scratch. With it, the Remix becomes a true *refresh*. Reimagine can say "your current About section reads X; change Y to Z" rather than producing generic recommendations you have to map onto your real profile yourself.

## How to export your LinkedIn as a PDF

LinkedIn has a built-in PDF export. It is on the desktop site (not the mobile app, which lacks the equivalent option).

### Step by step:

- Sign in to LinkedIn at **linkedin.com** on a desktop or laptop browser.
- Click your profile photo (top right) or the **Me** button in the navigation bar.
- Choose **View profile** from the dropdown. You should land on the page whose URL starts with `linkedin.com/in/your-handle`.
- Find the **More** button, shown as a ... (three-dot) icon. It sits in the section just below your name and headline, alongside buttons like **Open to**, **Add section**, and **Enhance profile**. LinkedIn changes these labels from time to time, but the ... (More) action is where the PDF export lives.
- Click the ... (More) button. A dropdown menu appears.
- Choose **Save to PDF**.
- The PDF downloads automatically to your default download folder. It will be named something like `Profile.pdf` or `[Your Name].pdf`.

If the ... (More) dropdown does not show **Save to PDF**, LinkedIn may be A/B testing a different layout for your account. The fallback is to copy your About section and any recommendations into the paste field on the Reimagine LinkedIn screen instead of uploading a PDF.

## On the Reimagine screen

Two ways to provide your LinkedIn content:

- **Upload the PDF** you just exported. Drag it onto the upload area or click to browse.
- **Paste content directly** into the text field below the upload area. Useful if you cannot get the PDF export to work, or if you only want to share specific sections (just the About section, say, or only your recommendations).

If you do not have a LinkedIn profile, or you do not want to share it, click **Skip this step**. The orientation continues. Reimagine will work without LinkedIn input; it just will not have the signal that LinkedIn provides.

When you have either uploaded or pasted (or chosen to skip), click **Continue**.

## Screen 5: Assessments

This is the input that does the most work. Read Chapter 3 if you have not already.

An assessment shows the durable part of you: where your natural strengths lie, what energizes you, and the environments where you do your best work. These qualities don't depend on title, compensation, or where you worked. They travel with you into every role that comes next, which is why this layer raises the quality of everything Reimagine generates downstream.

**Upload an assessment file.** PDF, Word, or text. The tool reads it and pastes the contents into the text field below.

**Or paste results directly.** Use the text field. You can paste the full report, a summary, or both.

**Assessment Type.** Pick one from the dropdown. This is informational; the actual analysis uses the text content.

**Multiple assessments.** If you have more than one, paste them sequentially into the text field with simple dividers like === CliftonStrengths === and === Hogan === between each. Reimagine will read all of it.

**No assessment yet?** Click the orange **Take the Free Affintus Assessment** button. It opens in a new tab, takes about 15 minutes, and produces results you can paste back here.

**If you try to skip this step,** Reimagine will pause and ask you once whether you are sure. The warning is real. You can skip. The tool will still generate output. But the output will be missing a layer.

Click **Continue** when you are done.

## Screen 6: Values, Passions & Causes

Two short fields. Both have a microphone button. You can speak your answers instead of typing them.

**Core Values. 3 to 5 non-negotiables.** The conditions under which you do your best work and feel most like yourself. Examples: independence, family, justice, stability, faith, intellectual challenge, service, wealth creation, cooperation. Be specific.

**Passions, Interests & Causes. 3 to 5 things you care about.** What you read about for fun, volunteer your time for, or could talk about for 30 minutes with no preparation. Hobbies, industries that fascinate you, communities you belong to, causes close to your heart.

**One thing worth knowing:** it can be tempting to filter your answers for what feels professionally relevant. Try not to. The Explore Options phase looks for unexpected combinations between your professional life and the rest of you, so the side project, the cause, the hobby, the industry you read about for fun are all worth including.

Both fields are required. Click **Continue**.

## Screen 7: Your Priorities & Non-Negotiables

Where Values covers *why* work matters to you, this screen covers the practical side: what you actually need for a move to be worth making. Every field is optional — fill in what applies and skip the rest.

- **Compensation floor.** The minimum total compensation that would make a move worth it. A number or a range is fine.
- **Commute or remote needs.** Anything firm about where and how you work — "remote only," "no more than 30 minutes," "hybrid, two days max."
- **How much benefits weigh.** A quick sense of how much a strong benefits package factors into your decision.
- **Stability or upside.** Which way you lean when a role trades security for potential.
- **Hard deal-breakers.** Anything you won't consider — an industry, an ownership structure, a company size. Leave blank if none.

Two of these do work right away: your deal-breakers and your stability-vs-upside lean shape which companies Go-to-Market surfaces for you, the same way your values and passions already do. The compensation floor and commute needs are held for later — they come back when you evaluate an actual offer, and they are never used to steer which directions or companies you see. Click **Continue** when you're done, or skip straight through if none apply.

## Screen 8: Reputation

Four short questions about what other people see in you. Each has a microphone button.

- **The Memory.** A specific moment when someone thanked or praised you at work. What was the situation, and what did they say?
- **The Emergency Call.** If your former team had a critical problem right now, what kind of situation would they call you to handle?
- **The Two Words.** If your best former manager described your professional superpower in exactly two words, what would they be?
- **Additional Feedback.** Performance reviews, LinkedIn recommendations, 360 feedback. Paste anything.

Spend a few minutes sourcing real material before you fill these in. Look at:

- Old performance reviews

- LinkedIn recommendations you have received
- 360 or peer feedback if you have it
- Notes, emails, or messages from former bosses, colleagues, clients, or partners where they said something specific you remember

If you have nothing in writing, sit with the questions for a moment. A moment of praise usually surfaces when you give yourself the space. The more specific the moment, the more useful it is. The Memory and the Emergency Call do the most work for the analysis that follows, so prioritize those.

Click **Continue** when you are done.

## Screen 9: Your Story (optional)

The final orientation step is the most personal one. Reimagine asks for a life experience that shapes how you work but is not on your resume. Where you grew up. A role you played in your family. A community commitment that runs across decades. The kind of thing that explains a recurring pattern in your career the resume cannot show.

The field is optional. Some users have rich material here; some do not. If you do, it becomes one of the strongest grounding sources Reimagine has for your Bridge Story and brand work, often the most distinctive thing the listener walks away remembering.

A canonical example: a first-generation American who grew up translating between immigrant parents and the new country develops a literal and cultural bilinguality that becomes a transferable strength for client-technical translation work. Nobody puts this on LinkedIn; everything in their career flows from it. Other shapes the field can take: a stretch of caregiving that built your tolerance for ambiguity, an athletic or artistic discipline carried since childhood, a defining loss, a community role that runs across decades.

A few prompts if you are stuck:

- A formative role you played in your family.
- A specific experience that shaped how you operate.
- A commitment you have held across decades.
- A way you have always been described that has nothing to do with your career.

The button at the bottom adapts. If you type anything, it reads **Continue**. If the field is empty, it reads **Continue without sharing** so the skip path is explicit. Both are valid.

When you click Continue, Reimagine moves you to Your Skills.

## Screen 10: Your Skills

After Your Story, Reimagine reads your resume and LinkedIn and extracts a categorized list of your hard skills: technical tools, systems and platforms, certifications, languages, and methodologies. The list shows up in a few seconds, organized into chips you can edit, remove, or add to.

This step is the missing piece of your Proficiency story. Documented skills are on your resume already, just buried in the accomplishment narrative. Skills you have picked up on side projects, fresh certifications you have not added to LinkedIn yet, languages you speak: those are invisible to a screener and to your future readers unless you surface them.

Confirm what is right. Remove what does not apply. Add what is missing. Reimagine uses this list to sharpen every downstream output: which options your background fits, which target companies match, what to highlight on your resume refresh, what to lead with on your LinkedIn headline.

A **Re-extract from my resume and LinkedIn** link below the chips re-runs the extraction. Use it if you have updated your resume since first reaching this step.

Click **Continue** when you are done.

## What happens next

When you finish Your Skills, Reimagine shows a short **Orientation complete** card before moving into Phase 1. The card acknowledges that you have finished the input phase: everything from here on is output. Read it, then click Continue.

From Phase 1 on, you are no longer entering data. You are reviewing what Reimagine generates from your inputs, telling it what to adjust where needed, and advancing to the next phase when each result feels right.

While Reimagine generates each section, the loading screen shows a short "while you wait" bullet list previewing what is coming, plus rotating quotes from Bob Goodwin's book *Making Your Own Weather*. Each phase has its own pool of quotes matched to that phase's substance.

If at any point you realize an input was wrong or incomplete, click any completed orientation step in the left sidebar to return, fix it, and regenerate from there. Chapter 12 explains how to do that without losing your downstream work.

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*Next: Phase 1. Know Your Value →*



## 5. Phase 1. Know Your Value

*(KYV consolidated 2026-05-20. Phase 1 used to be three user-visible steps; now it is one: Personal Brand.)*

This is the foundation phase. Everything you generate later in the journey: your bridge story, your target companies, your outreach, your LinkedIn, your resume refresh, your playbook. All of it is built on what comes out of Phase 1. If the foundation is sharp, everything downstream is sharp. If the foundation is generic, the rest of the journey carries that around.

Plan to spend more time reading and refining Phase 1 than any later phase. The 15 minutes you spend here saves an hour of refining downstream.

### One step, one read

Phase 1 is a single step: **Personal Brand**. You click one button, you wait once, and you get one flowing prose synthesis of who you are at work. Behind the scenes Reimagine runs a two-stage build: a deep read of everything you provided, then the synthesis that turns it into your brand. Neither stage reaches the screen as a separate output. The integration is the deliverable.

The synthesis pulls from everything you provided in Orientation: your resume, your assessment, your values, your passions, your reputation answers, your life-shaping experiences. The two stages feed each other and produce a single read, laid out as a set of components that appear only when your inputs earn them.

### On the screen

Click **Build My Personal Brand**. The full generation takes about three to four minutes. Reimagine shows a rotating quote from a thinker on purpose, leadership, or resilience while the work runs. A short stage line above the quote tells you where in the build Reimagine is:

- **Reading your inputs** while it studies your resume, your assessment, and the rest of your orientation
- **Writing your synthesis** while it composes your Personal Brand

The quote is for you, not for the analysis. Use the time.

### What you will get back

Personal Brand comes back as a designed read, not a wall of text. It opens with one line, then lays out only the parts your inputs actually support, so a sparse profile reads short and a rich one reads full. Nothing is padded to fill a slot. You may see:

- **A through-line at the top.** One sentence naming what runs through your work, specific enough that it could not be lifted onto anyone else in your role.

- **A proof strip.** When your inputs carry several quantified results, the strongest few sit in a row near the top as a quick scan layer. With only one or two, the numbers stay inline in the prose.
- **Sections, each led by a short label.** The body of the read, in the order the analysis makes its case. The labels are the scan layer; the prose underneath rewards the deep read.
- **Where it comes from.** When your life-shaping inputs hold a real formative source, it gets its own set-apart passage. If your story inputs are thin, there is no origin section, and Reimagine will not invent one.
- **Worth naming.** A short set of growth edges, each named the way a trusted coach names a watch-out: matter-of-fact, useful, and resolved into how to use it. Only when your inputs surfaced real ones.
- **What is next.** A warm close that points toward Phase 2 without picking a lane for you.

You can keep a copy any time with **Save as PDF**, which opens a clean print-or-save view of the read. Re-running replaces your current Personal Brand, so save first if you want to hold on to a version.

## What good looks like

Three checks as you read:

- **Does the opening line sound like you, and only you?** A strong brand's first sentence could not be lifted onto anyone else in your role. If it could, ask Reimagine to push harder.
- **Does it sound like a person, not just a professional?** The best brands connect your work to what shaped you. If it reads as all competence and no human, ask Reimagine to bring more of you in.
- **Does it point somewhere, not just back?** The close should open real possibilities for what is next, not restate where you have already been. If it plays it safe, ask it to push further.

## How to refine

Below the read, the **Does this feel right?** box accepts both factual corrections and interpretive pushback. Tell Reimagine what to adjust, then click **Update with my changes**. The microphone button is here too: speak instead of typing if it is easier. The whole read regenerates with your correction folded in, and the correction stays in your profile so every later section honors it.

Refinement patterns that work well:

- **Push back on the through-line if the read is wrong.** "The through-line should center on building new operating models from scratch. The work has been greenfield rather than turnaround. Rework the lead if it shifts."
- **Correct a fact that landed in the prose.** "The Acme integration was a hostile take-under, not a friendly merger. That changes the read on the customer-retention number. Rework that paragraph."
- **Ask for more of the human.** "The read is all competence. The years I spent caring for a parent shaped how I lead under pressure. Bring that in if the inputs support it."

- **Add missing context that is not on the resume.** "I led the post-acquisition integration after the Acme deal closed; that is not on the resume because we kept it quiet at the time. Fold it in."

Use **Start fresh** to clear your correction and regenerate from scratch.

Either way, Reimagine keeps the version you had just before. If a refresh comes back weaker than what you had, click **Restore previous version** on the Personal Brand screen to switch back, and switch again if you change your mind. It keeps the most recent prior version, so you can always compare the two.

## When you are happy with it

Click **Put It to Work** to advance to Phase 2: Apply Your Foundation. Personal Brand becomes the source of truth Reimagine uses to generate everything that follows. The dimensions you and Reimagine surfaced as worth examining (often scale, mission, or position in the value chain) are exactly what Phase 2's Put It to Work choice is designed to sharpen.

## Phase 1 in one paragraph

You arrived in Phase 1 with a resume, an assessment, your values, your passions, what others say about you, and a life-shaping experience or two. You leave with one document: a single integrated read of who you are at work, with a forward-looking translation of where the through-line applies and a dimensional reading that names the choices worth sharpening in Phase 2. Behind the scenes Reimagine ran a two-stage build against your inputs; on the screen you saw one CTA, one wait, and one synthesis. If you ever need to start over on a downstream step, the easiest fix is usually to come back to Phase 1, refine here, and let the changes flow forward. Chapter 12 covers the mechanics.

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*Next: Phase 2. Explore Options →*

## 6. Phase 2. Apply Your Foundation

*(Bridge Story structure updated 2026-05-19; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)*

This is the phase where the tool earns its name. You probably see one or two obvious next steps: a similar role at a similar company, or maybe one logical pivot. Phase 2 is where you actually *reimagine* what is possible. It puts a wider field in front of you, one direction at a time, and then builds a complete playbook for any role you want to pursue.

After Personal Brand, Reimagine asks a simple question before anything else.

### Put It to Work

The first screen in Phase 2 opens with the headline "**Put It to Work**" and a short framing: *Your foundation is set. Pick how to put it to use. You can come back to this choice anytime from the sidebar.* Both choices below are real options. Neither is the "right" one.

Below the framing line, two cards sit side by side. Each carries an icon, a title, a one-line value statement, a short body, a preview footer (what you will see and how long it takes), and a call-to-action button.

**Career Paths.** Titled **Career Paths** with a route icon in gold. The body reads: *See role options across Familiar Ground (where your credibility extends), Industry Insider (where your sector knowledge translates), and Work That Matters (where your values point).* The preview footer notes that you will see three directions with role candidates and reasoning, and that it takes about 90 seconds to generate. The primary CTA on this card is **Start Exploring** → (solid gold button). Choose this when you want the tool to widen the field for you.

**Add an Opportunity.** Titled **Add an Opportunity** with a target icon in blue. The body reads: *Paste a job description and get a focused playbook for that exact role: how you fit, how to position yourself, what the conversation looks like. Add as many opportunities as you want.* The preview footer notes that you will see a playbook with four sections built on demand for one specific job, about 30 seconds per section. The CTA on this card is **Add an Opportunity** → (outlined blue button). Choose this when you already have a posting in hand and want Reimagine focused on it. (Add an Opportunity is covered in Chapter 11b.)

Above the two cards, a single guidance line reads: *Not sure which to pick first? Career Paths is a good place to start: it shows the range of where your background takes you. Come back to add an opportunity once you have a specific role in mind.* The two paths are not mutually exclusive. Choose either one, finish what you need, and the other is available from the sidebar entry **Put It to Work** anytime.

If you are returning after a previous version of Reimagine, a short welcome-back note appears above the headline. Your story (resume, assessment, values, reputation, Personal Brand) is exactly where you left it. Roles you explored before regenerate fresh from your latest inputs. If you want to keep a prior playbook word for word, save its PDF (see "Save your playbook" below).

## Career Paths: pick a direction

Career Paths leads to **three directions to consider**. You pick one to start with, and you can come back to the others anytime.

**Familiar Ground.** Same kind of work, in a new seat. A bigger scope, the same role at a different company, or your function applied in a new industry. Your track record speaks immediately because the work itself is familiar territory.

**Industry Insider.** Your industry expertise, in more places than you might think. Employers consistently prefer candidates who already understand their industry, so the wider set of organizations around your current role holds more options than you may realize: clients, vendors, consultants, regulators, adjacent players. Same insider knowledge, broader spectrum of seats.

**Work That Matters.** A real pivot toward meaning. Built on the intersection of what you love, what you are good at, what the world needs, and what you can be paid for. The biggest move of the three, and the one that most often stretches beyond your current title.

Pick the one that fits the kind of move you want to explore first. This is not a final decision. You can explore all three over time, and your options for each direction are kept so you can flip back without regenerating.

## The Lane Option view

Once you pick a direction, Reimagine generates a focused set of roles for that direction only, drawing on everything from Phase 1 plus your location and work preferences.

At the top, a single **umbrella paragraph** carries the credibility case for the direction once: it inherits your through-line from your Personal Brand, applies the strategic question this direction asks (where does your credibility extend; where does your industry knowledge translate; where do your values point), and reads the dimensional fit between who you are and what you have been doing. The umbrella is the analytical anchor for the whole direction.

Below the umbrella, the role options. Each card is minimal by design:

- **A title.** A specific role you could pursue, as it would appear on a posting or business card.
- **An organization type.** The kind of organization that hires this role.
- **A vehicle.** How the role is structured (W-2, consulting, fractional, advisory, board, founding or buying something).
- **A sector.** The industry or position in the ecosystem.

Some cards add a short bullet underneath when a specific role-context requirement intersects with a specific piece of your background in a way the umbrella did not already cover. Most cards do not; the umbrella did the analytical work for the direction, and the cards carry direction rather than re-stating the case six times.

Click any role to build its full playbook (the Focus Playbook, below).

**Fewer than expected is honest, not broken.** Reimagine will not pad a weak direction to hit a count. If only one or two strong options exist at this level for you, it says so and points you to the input box where you can name a direction we missed or refine the set, or to try another direction. An honest short list is more useful than a padded one.

#### **Bottom of the screen:**

- **Tell us where else to look.** Opens a short input box. Name a domain or direction we should consider, or tell Reimagine what did not fit, and it re-runs with your input weighted, without repeating what you have already seen. This input shapes the options only; it does not change anything downstream.
- **Explore another direction.** Returns to the three directions. Your current direction's options are preserved.
- **Back to a direction you already generated.** If you have looked at more than one direction this session, you can flip straight back to a previous one without regenerating it.

## **The Focus Playbook**

Click a role and Reimagine builds a **Focus Playbook**: a single, assembled page that holds everything for that one role. This replaces the old compare-three-options step. You commit attention to one role at a time and build it out as far as you want.

**An orientation card at the top of the page** names what the page is and how the sections fit together. It carries an eyebrow ("How to use your playbook"), a one-sentence framing, a 2-column grid that lists the four groups and the sections inside each, and a short closer that points at the Save Playbook as PDF button at the bottom.

**The Role generates immediately.** The first section, The Role, generates the moment you click in: what the role actually is, why you fit, and what to think through before going deeper. You read this first to decide whether the role is worth more of your time.

**Everything else generates on demand.** The remaining sections each have a Generate button. Before you click, every section shows a one-line subhead under its heading naming what the section produces, plus a short detail panel that adds two or three sentences on what feeds the section and what to do with the output.

You build the playbook at your own pace, in the order that fits you. The seven numbered sections are grouped into four named groups so the arc is legible at a glance:

#### **Group 1 · Understand the role**

- **The Role.** What the role is, why you fit, what to weigh.

#### **Group 2 · Build your story**

- **Your Bridge Story.** The 30-second answer that connects where you have been to where you are going.

- **Industry Background.** The vocabulary, tools, and players that signal credibility in this space.

### Group 3 • Prepare for the conversation

- **Interview Prep.** The questions this role will surface, with STAR stories woven in so each story sits next to the question it best answers.

### Group 4 • Carry it into the market

- **Resume Refresh.** Your resume reframed for this direction, ready to download as a Word document.
- **LinkedIn Remix.** Headline, About, and experience copy you paste into your profile yourself.
- **Go-to-Market.** Live research into target companies and the people inside them, with an outreach approach.

**Bonus • Income Now.** Bridge income that can run alongside the main strategy while you search. Renders below the four groups as a bonus stripe, not numbered alongside the seven.

The arc has a logic: **confirm the role, test the fit, prepare the materials, learn where to apply.** The first sections are fit tests (can I tell this story, do I know the language, can I handle the questions, do I have the proof). The middle sections prepare your materials. Go-to-Market sits late on purpose: it is the most expensive section to generate, so you only pay for it once you have confirmed the role is worth pursuing. A user who stops after Bridge Story never burns the heavy research call.

Each section has a "Does this feel right?" box. Refining a section regenerates just that section. It does not wipe the rest of your playbook. If you want another section to reflect a change, regenerate that one too (one click).

## Save your playbook

A footer bar appears at the bottom of the Focus Playbook once you have generated any section. It carries a **Save Playbook as PDF** button that stays in view as you scroll.

Your playbook is saved to your account and you can switch between roles in My Playbooks without losing work. The PDF is for moments when you want a portable copy: sending to a coach or mentor, reading on a device where you're not signed in, or keeping an annotated reference alongside your offline notes.

## My Playbooks

Every role you build a Focus Playbook for is saved to your account and appears in **My Playbooks** in the sidebar. Open any of them to pick up where you left off; your sections, your inputs, and your refinements are all there.

## A reminder you can come back to

You only need one new job. But you can explore as many directions and roles as you want. Your Phase 1 work (Personal Brand) stays constant. Only the parts that depend on the role you are looking

at get rewritten when you switch. The tool is designed to open your eyes to what is possible, not to corner you into one answer.

## **Phase 2 in one paragraph**

You came in with a clear professional identity from Phase 1. You leave Phase 2 having seen a wider field one direction at a time, and with a complete, single-role playbook for any role worth your attention. Save the playbooks you want to keep, re-explore freely, and choose your next chapter knowing you have seen the field.

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*Next: Phase 3. Tell Your Story →*



## 7. Phase 3. Tell Your Story

*Where this lives now.* Your Bridge Story is generated inside the Focus Playbook for a specific role (Chapter 6), as the second section after *The Role*. It is no longer a separate phase you walk to in order. This chapter explains what the Bridge Story is and what good looks like; the Focus Playbook is where you generate and refine it.

*What changed (2026-05-31).* Reimagine used to give you the bones of an answer: three building blocks, three starter options for each, that you assembled and edited into a finished story. It now writes a single cohesive answer in your voice, calibrated to the direction you picked, and offers a coaching note when a second strong opening is also visible in your profile. The reason for the change is below.

This phase has one step, and it carries more weight than its size suggests: your **Bridge Story**.

"Tell me about yourself" is the first question in almost every meaningful professional conversation. A first phone call with a recruiter. The opening 30 seconds of an interview. A networking introduction at a conference. A cold meeting with someone who agreed to give you 20 minutes. The answer you give in those 30 seconds sets the tone for everything that follows.

The most common answer is a chronological recap of the career, starting with the current title and walking backwards. That answer is forgettable. It is also, increasingly, exactly what large language models produce when you ask them to summarize a resume. It does not differentiate you, because it could describe a thousand other senior professionals.

The Bridge Story uses a different formula. It connects who you are *as a person* to what you have *done* to where you are *headed*. When all three parts connect, the listener walks away thinking "of course that is what they should do next." That is the conversation you want.

This phase is short. Get it right.

### Why it is a written answer again

An earlier version gave you the bones and asked you to assemble the finished story yourself. That worked for some people and slowed others down. The discipline of the three-part shape was right; the picker UI got in the way of the read-and-refine flow you use everywhere else in Reimagine.

So the model now writes a single cohesive answer in your voice, and the standard refine box is how you adjust it: open it, say what is off, regenerate. The three-part formula is still the spine of the prompt, but you no longer see the seams.

### What this step does

Reimagine writes a single tell-me-about-yourself answer for the direction you picked at the end of Phase 2. It draws from your Orientation inputs and your Personal Brand. The structure underneath is the *Making Your Own Weather* formula:

- **Something human about you.** Before career, function, or resume. The strongest, most distinctive human anchor your inputs offer: a hobby, an interest, a passion, a formative training or skill, a relationship, or an early-life experience. Not a job title. Reimagine picks the anchor that gives a listener the quickest signal of who you are; it does not default to a childhood story when a passion or a craft you trained in says more about how you work. This is what makes you the one person in the conversation they remember.
- **Your career in action.** Lead with the theme, not a list of wins. The theme is the through-line your Personal Brand already named: the one force that runs through your work. Reimagine states that force in plain language, then grounds it with a single illustrative example, one accomplishment framed as money made, money saved, or risk mitigated with a number, chosen because it shows the force best. One well-chosen example lands harder than three stacked together.
- **Where you are going next.** Why your chosen direction is the natural next step, falling out of the same force that runs through the first two parts, not a change of subject and not a role description.

Those three labels never appear on the page. You see one flowing answer. The shape is invisible.

## Lane-aware: same person, different opening

The same person has more than one true opening. Which one resonates depends on who is across the table. So the lane you picked in Phase 2 shapes which human anchor the model foregrounds:

- **Familiar Ground** foregrounds the anchor most tied to your professional craft or operating instinct: what makes you effective at this kind of work, as a person, not just a credential.
- **Industry Insider** foregrounds the anchor most tied to your domain curiosity: why this world has always fascinated you, what you see from the inside that others miss.
- **Work That Matters** foregrounds the anchor most tied to your values, passion, or cause: what you care about in the world, with your career as proof you can deliver on it.

If you change direction later, regenerate the Bridge Story and the opening adjusts.

## The optional coaching note

After the story, if your profile clearly carries a second distinct opening (different anchor, not a variation of the same one) and that second opening would be more resonant in a specific kind of conversation, Reimagine surfaces it as a short italic coaching note below the story.

The coaching note is one or two sentences. It names what the story led with and when the alternative would serve you better. There is no button to switch. If you want to act on it, open the refine box and ask for the alternative as the opening.

When your profile has one dominant through-line, no coaching note appears. The omission is the signal: there is one strong way to open, not two.

## The memorability principle (why the opening never leads with a title)

The single biggest reason most tell-me-about-yourself answers are forgettable is that they open with a role. "I am a senior product leader with 15 years of experience." Everyone in the room can say a version of that. *Making Your Own Weather* is firm on this: starting with the human is what makes the answer stick.

The prompt forbids title-first, time-anchor, and credential-first openings. If your story ever lands with one anyway, open the refine box, say "lead with [specific human anchor] instead," and regenerate.

## What makes an anchor land: the evidence test

Every trait Reimagine surfaces in your Bridge Story comes with three things: an anchor the listener can verify, your own words explaining what it means, and a recognition move that locates it in your work. A claim without those three reads as performance. With them, it reads as something you have lived. That is the difference between "I am a strategic thinker," which the listener has heard a hundred times and cannot check, and an opening they actually believe.

The anchor can come from any of four places. One example of each:

- **A formative experience.** "I was sixteen when my dad was laid off after twenty-two years, and I watched how badly the company handled the goodbye. Every system I have built since starts from one question: would this hold up on the worst day?"
- **A passion or hobby.** "I have raced bikes for fifteen years. It taught me when to sit in and when to spend everything I have, and that is exactly how I read a product roadmap."
- **A training or craft.** "I trained as a classical violinist before I ever ran an operation. Conservatory teaches you two things at once: master your own part, then tune it to everyone else in the ensemble. That is how I run a launch."
- **An assessment result.** "I am not sure if you know CliftonStrengths, but my top theme is Restorative. The way I understand it is that I am wired to fix what is broken. I never had a name for it before, but it describes exactly what I have done for eighteen years." An assessment anchor needs all three beats: the graceful intro that does not assume the listener knows the framework, your own plain-language definition, and the recognition that it named something you already saw in yourself. Without them, it sounds like reading a test score out loud.

*Coming later: value-anchored stories.* A real, deeply held value, the kind whose opposite a reasonable person could also choose, can make a strong opening. Reimagine will support value-anchored bridge stories in a future release, once the assessment integration deepens enough to source values reliably. For now, if your own inputs already carry a clear value, it can still surface in your story; Reimagine just does not go looking for one yet.

## On the screen

The Bridge Story section opens with a short section header and a generate button. Click **Generate**. About a minute to a minute and a half. You get the story and, when one is warranted, the coaching note. Below them, the standard refine box ("Does this feel right?") and the navigation to **Find My Market**.

## What good looks like

This is a story you will say to real humans, so the test is whether it sounds like you saying it.

**Read it out loud.** Not in your head. Out loud, at a conversational pace. If you stumble over a phrase, that phrase needs to come out. If you would not use a word in conversation, that word does not belong.

**Check the opening.** It should be something true about you as a person, not a credential, and it should be the strongest anchor you have, whether that is a passion, a craft you trained in, an interest, a relationship, or an early experience. A strong opening sounds like:

*I have always been the person who figures out why something is not selling and then fixes it.*

A weak opening sounds like:

*I am a results-driven leader with 20 years of experience in enterprise sales.*

The first starts with the human and pivots into the career. The second starts with the credential. The model leads with the first by default. If your refinement nudges it toward the second, you have edited the memorability out of your own answer.

**Check the middle.** The career section should lead with the theme, not a list of accomplishments. It names the one force that runs through your work and grounds it in a single, well-chosen example. *Because* you are the person who figures out what is broken, you walked into the company where the sales engine was broken and rebuilt it: one story, told because it carries the theme, not three stacked to prove range. The "because" is the connective tissue. If the middle reads as a résumé in sentences, or as two unrelated halves, ask the refine box to lead with the theme and pick the single best example.

**Check the close.** The forward move should make your next chapter feel inevitable, not aspirational. "I am looking for a CRO role at a mission-driven career services platform because I have already built this from scratch once, and I want to do it at a scale where it reaches thousands instead of hundreds" lands. "I am exploring opportunities where I can apply my experience" does not.

**Watch the metaphor.** If a metaphor opens the story (music, cycling, fishing, taking things apart), it should establish the frame and then recede. Look for one callback in the work paragraph and one light touch at the close, not the metaphor running through every sentence. If the same image returns three times in one paragraph, the medicine is over-applied; ask the refine box to carry the work in plain language and save the frame for the open and the close. The listener should feel the frame without watching for it.

**Time it.** A good tell-me-about-yourself runs 30 to 45 seconds spoken. If yours runs longer than 60 seconds at conversational pace, ask the refine box to tighten. If it runs under 20, you have probably cut too far and should regenerate.

## How to refine

The refine box ("Does this feel right?" below the story) is your tool. Open it, write what is off, and regenerate. The microphone in the box lets you talk through what feels off; that is often easier than typing it.

Useful patterns:

- "The opening leans on my volunteer work. Lead with the assessment finding instead."
- "Keep using the divestiture story. The migration project is more transferable for this role."
- "The close is too big. Pull it back to something more measured."
- "Translate the accomplishments out of my old industry's language. A healthcare CEO would not follow these."
- "I want to lead with my sustainability work for mission-driven conversations. Use that as the opening."

Use **Update with my changes** to fold the change in. Use **Start fresh** to clear and regenerate from a different angle.

If you ever want a completely different opening because the conversation in front of you calls for it, the refine box is also where you do that. Tell the model which anchor to lead with and it will rewrite around that choice.

## The op-card adaptation

Each Live Opportunity Playbook (Chapter 11b) you build also has a Bridge Story card. That card is a 2 to 3 sentence sharpening of your role-level story, tuned to the specific company and job description for that opportunity.

It does two things your base Bridge Story cannot: it names *why this company specifically*, and (when the company's mission calls for it) it shifts the human anchor to the angle most resonant for that role. The result is a 30-second opener you can take into that conversation without rewriting from scratch.

The op card uses your role-level Bridge Story as its starting point, so build that first. If you click **Build** on the op Bridge Story card before the role-level one exists, it will tell you what to do. The op card has its own refine box; refinements there stay scoped to that opportunity and never overwrite your base Bridge Story.

## Do not try to memorize it

The story is an *illustration of the structure*, not a script. People who memorize their tell-me-about-yourself almost always sound stiff, and the rhythm of a real conversation rarely lets you deliver 30 memorized seconds anyway. The other person nods or interrupts or asks a question, and the script falls apart.

What you are internalizing is the three-part formula:

- **What is true about you as a human.** The strongest anchor you have: a passion, a craft you trained in, an interest, a relationship, or an early experience, whichever signals most about who you are.
- **How that has played out in your career.** The one force that runs through your work, grounded in a single example that shows it, framed as money made, money saved, or risk mitigated. Not a list.
- **Therefore, what you are looking for.** Why your next chapter is the natural extension of that same force.

Once the three are alive in your head, you can land them in your own words, in any order the moment allows, in 30 seconds or 90. That is how a Bridge Story works in the wild: not a recital, three ideas you are comfortable enough with to assemble on the fly.

## When your Orientation changes later

The Bridge Story is generated from a snapshot of your Orientation. If you change your reputation, values, passions, assessment, frameworks, or Your Story after generating, regenerate the Bridge Story so the opening reflects what is now true. The Focus Playbook will prompt you when an earlier section needs a refresh.

## When the inputs are thin

If your Orientation does not carry enough material for a specific, evidence-anchored story, the story you get back will name only what your inputs actually support. Reimagine does not fabricate. Add what is true (a side project, an assessment finding, a formative experience in Your Story), regenerate, and the new story will have more to work from.

Honest thin beats fabricated full. A short, specific story is more useful than a long story that makes claims you cannot trace to anything.

## Why this output flows into so many later steps

Your Bridge Story becomes the input to:

- The opening of your **LinkedIn About section** in Phase 5. The first three lines are what shows above the "see more" cutoff, and most readers see only those. Reimagine uses your Bridge Story as the anchor for them.
- Your **answer to "tell me about yourself"** in Interview Prep. It reads your Bridge Story directly, so the work you do refining here carries straight in.
- The voice template for your **outreach** in Phase 4. The way you sound in your Bridge Story sets the tone for how Reimagine drafts your peer-to-peer outreach.
- The **Bridge Story card** in any Live Opportunity Playbook you build, as described above.

Because the Bridge Story is a saved asset, the time you spend refining it until it sounds like you is time you do not spend re-fixing every downstream output that inherits its voice.

## When you are happy with it

Click **Find My Market** to advance to Phase 4. If something feels off later, say you read your LinkedIn copy in Phase 5 and the opening line sounds off. You can come back here, refine, and let the LinkedIn step regenerate. Chapter 12 covers how.

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*Next: Phase 4. Find Your Market →*

## 8. Phase 4. Find Your Market

*(Bridge Story structure updated 2026-05-19; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)*

**Where this lives now.** Go-to-Market is generated inside the Focus Playbook for a specific role (Chapter 6), in the Go-to-Market section. It sits late in the playbook arc on purpose: it runs live web research and is the most expensive section to generate, so you build it once you have confirmed the role is worth pursuing. This chapter explains what it produces and what good looks like.

This phase has one step: your **Go-to-Market Strategy**.

The best opportunities are filled through relationships, not job boards. This phase is about getting you in front of the people making hiring decisions before any posting goes live.

### Why reach out to companies that have not posted a role for you

This is the most reasonable question to ask about the whole phase. If a company has not posted the role you want, why email a senior leader there?

Two reasons, both common, both why this approach works.

**Reason one: the role exists, but the seat is wobbly.** Many of the roles you would target already exist at your target companies. There is already a CFO, a VP of Sales, a Head of People in place. But not every person in those seats is the strongest player on the team. Some are underperforming, some are on the way out, some are about to be moved sideways in a reorg the rest of the company has not heard about. When you show up with a sharp value proposition and a track record of doing exactly what that company needs, you look like a major upgrade. The fact that the seat is technically filled does not mean leadership is satisfied with how it is filled. Hiring decisions get made on exactly that gap.

**Reason two: the role is forming, but has not surfaced yet.** The other common scenario is that the hiring manager is already considering the role. Or, at minimum, recognizes an unmet need they have not yet communicated to HR. There is no posting, no job description, no requisition number, none of the formal apparatus. The decision to hire is somewhere between a thought and a budget line. When you show up in that executive's inbox at exactly that moment with exactly the right background. Directly, or through a warm networking contact. You look like a gift. The role gets shaped around you instead of you trying to fit into a role that was shaped without you.

Both of these happen all the time. Together, they have a name: **the hidden job market**. These are the roles that exist or are forming inside companies but never make it to a public posting. The hidden market gets missed for a simple reason. Waiting for a posting before reaching out means you only ever see the *third* category: the role that has been formed, approved, written up, and made public, with everyone else's resume already in the queue. By the time you are competing on a public posting, the easiest version of the conversation is already over.

### The way every good salesperson thinks about this



A job posting is essentially an RFP. A request for proposal. The company has decided what it wants, written it down, and is now collecting submissions from anyone who shows up.

No good salesperson hits their quota by waiting for RFPs. Good salespeople know their territory. They know what they are selling. They know who would benefit from it. And they reach out proactively. Before the buyer has gotten to the point of writing an RFP, while there is still room to shape the conversation.

That is exactly what this phase is built to do. Your target company list is your territory. Your Personal Brand and Bridge Story are what you are selling. The outreach template is your call.

And here is the part that makes this game different from sales: **your quota is one**. You only need one yes. The whole point of this phase is to fill your pipeline with more opportunities than just the RFPs everyone else is chasing, so that when the right yes shows up, you are ready and the conversation is already shaped around you.

## What this step does

Reimagine does live web research to identify a list of target companies that fit your background and the direction you chose, then identifies the most likely hiring decision-maker at each one and drafts a personalized outreach email you can send today.

It produces four things:

- **The hiring executive profile.** Who you should be reaching, by title, organization type, and the business challenge they are accountable for solving.
- **A target company list.** 10 companies to start (a **Find 10 More Companies** button pulls another batch of 10 whenever you want a bigger field), prioritized by signs of growth (recent funding, acquisitions, expansion) and flagged or removed if they show signs of contraction (layoffs, hiring freezes, leadership departures). Each company includes a name, what they do in one sentence, industry, size, HQ, a one-sentence reason it fits, a growth signal, the contact person where Reimagine could find one (with the source cited so you can verify), and the likely email convention.
- **An outreach template.** A complete three-paragraph email written in the *Making Your Own Weather* direct outreach format, plus a personalization guide so you can adapt it per company.
- **A LinkedIn signal tweak.** One specific headline recommendation positioned for this exact target.

## On the screen

The Phase 4 entry screen opens with an in-app framing card titled "A brand new lane to pursue." It captures, in shorter form, the same point this chapter makes at length: LinkedIn and job boards put you in a queue with everyone else; recruiters and referrals require someone else to act first; direct outreach is the path of agency. Read it if you want a punchier version of the case for this approach.

Click **Build My Strategy** to generate. This step uses live web research and is the most thorough generation in the journey: expect two to three minutes.

[screenshot: the loading screen with the message "Building your go-to-market strategy with live research..."]

## What you will get back

- **Quick Takeaway.** Who the hiring executive is, how many target companies were found, and the single most actionable thing to do this week.
- **Part 1. The Hiring Executive.** A specific profile of who you are trying to reach.
- **Part 2. Target Company List.** Each entry in a structured block: company name, what they do in one sentence, industry, size, HQ, why it fits, growth signal, contact person and title, source (website / LinkedIn / press release / news, so you can verify), and email convention. Each entry may also include a **"Why this might resonate for you"** line that names the specific connection between the company and something you said in Orientation, drawn from your passions, values, or life experiences. The line appears only when the connection is concrete; if no clear fit is visible from your inputs, Reimagine omits the line rather than inventing one. When the company's own site does not name the hiring manager, Reimagine runs a background LinkedIn search to surface the most likely current decision-maker, and labels each contact by where the name came from ("confirmed via company site" or "likely — via LinkedIn"). It says "Contact not identified" only when even that search finds no one, rather than guessing. A reminder above the list tells you to verify contact information before reaching out. Names sourced from public material can be out of date.
- **Part 3. Outreach Template.** A complete three-paragraph email using the strongest company as an example, plus a personalization guide.
- **Part 4. LinkedIn Signal Tweak.** A recommended headline with reasoning.

## What good looks like

The target list should feel mostly right. Some companies will be exactly right, some will be close, and a few may be off. That is normal. The list starts at 10 to keep the research fast and reliable, and a **Find 10 More Companies** button pulls another batch of 10 (optionally steered — "more early-stage startups," "companies in the Southeast") and adds them to the list. The point is a strong working field you keep building, not a perfect first ten. You will refine.

The outreach template should sound like a real email from a peer, not a sales pitch. It should reference something specific about the company in the first paragraph. If the email reads as transactional or generic, refine it.

The LinkedIn headline tweak should make sense for the role you are pursuing. The first 50 to 70 characters matter most. That is what shows in search results and connection requests.

## Adding more companies to your list

The list starts with 10 companies to keep the research fast and reliable. Right below the list, the **Add more companies to your list** panel lets you build it out whenever you want. You can do either or both

of two things:

- **Get 10 more.** Click **Find 10 More Companies** and Reimagine researches another 10 that fit your direction and adds them to the list. Your existing companies stay; the new ones are checked against them, so you never get a duplicate. Click it as many times as you like.
- **Steer the next 10.** Before you click, use the **"What should the next 10 focus on?"** field to point the search at what matters to you — for example "earlier-stage startups," "companies in the Southeast," or "mission-driven organizations." Leave it blank and the next 10 simply match the kind of companies already on your list.

The Download CSV and everything else update to include the companies you add.

## How to refine

This is the second-most-refined step in Reimagine, after Role Options. Common refinements:

- "Focus on companies in the Southeast. I'm not relocating from Atlanta."
- "Add more startups and fewer enterprise companies."
- "The outreach tone is too formal. I'd write more directly than this."
- "Remove the companies that are over 5,000 employees."
- "I want the email to lead with a specific point I can make about their recent funding round."

There are two ways to reshape the list, right under it, each its own card:

- **Rebuild the list.** Under **"Want a different set of companies?"**, tell Reimagine what you are after — size, stage, mission, geography ("mid-market instead of enterprise," "lean toward the Southeast," "closer to the mission angle") — and click **Rebuild the list**. It rebuilds the list around what you asked for, re-ranked. Part 1 (the hiring executive) and the outreach template stay as they are.
- **Add more without rebuilding.** Use the **Find 10 More Companies** panel described above and put your focus in its field; it appends a fresh batch and leaves the companies you already have in place.

## Download your company list as a spreadsheet

Right after the company list, Reimagine shows a gold callout with a **Download CSV** button. Click it and Reimagine downloads the entire list as a spreadsheet with these columns:

- Company
- What they do
- Industry
- Size
- HQ
- Why it fits

- Growth signal
- Contact
- Email

The filename is keyed to your name, the role you are pursuing, and the date. So multiple downloads stay organized.

This is one of the most useful features in the whole tool. Open it in Excel, Google Sheets, or Numbers, and you have a working outreach tracker. Add columns as you go: when you reached out, who you reached out to, what you heard back, what the next step is. Sort by growth signal. Filter by industry. Share a copy with your coach or a friend in your target space and ask for warm intros. Walk into a referral conversation with a list in hand. That signals a level of preparation almost no other candidate brings.

A few people keep a "live" version of the CSV that they update as the search progresses, and a separate copy of the original Reimagine output for reference. That works well.

## Roles open right now

Right after Reimagine builds your company list, it quietly checks each company in the background for a job that is open **right now** and is a real match for the direction you chose — matched by function rather than exact title (a "Head of People" counts for a "Chief People Officer" search). This runs on its own; you do not click anything.

When it finds one, a **green flag** appears at the top of that company's card: "A role that fits is open right now." Click it to see the specific role, a direct link to the posting, and a one-line note on why it fits. Companies without a current match stay quiet — no flag, no "nothing found" message. Most companies will not have a matching role open at any given moment, so the green flag is meant to feel like a find: when it shows up, there is a real opening to act on today.

The check reads the open web, so it reflects what is actually posted now and updates as companies post new roles. It runs once per company and is saved with your playbook, so reopening the list is instant.

## Learn more about this company

Each company in the list carries a full-width amber action button anchored to the bottom of the card, labeled **Learn more about [Company Name]** (the actual company name is substituted into the button copy). Click it for a focused read on that company beyond what you would find on Glassdoor: news from the last 90 days, the employee voice, industry-specific signal (CMS Star Ratings for hospital systems, GitHub cadence for tech, FINRA filings for financial services, and similar by sector), the leadership's public footprint, and watch-outs named honestly. Every numeric or named factual claim cites its source URL inline. The card uses live web search, so it takes roughly 30 to 60 seconds per click.

The button is intentionally prominent — full card width, solid amber fill — because the read is one of the most useful things you can pull from this page. Once you have built it, the rendered content takes the

place of the button inline within the same company card; a smaller **Rebuild** button at the bottom right lets you refresh against newer signal if the original is more than a few weeks old.

This is opt-in per company. Reimagine does not bulk-fire it across the list. Click only on the companies you are seriously considering; each read is saved with your Focus Playbook and you can return to it later from My Playbooks.

The deepened read complements the company card above it (the What they do / Industry / Size / HQ / Why it fits / Growth signal block), going beyond rather than restating that signal. It does not replace your own judgment; it surfaces signal you would not otherwise know to look for, with sources cited so you can verify before you act.

If the Go-to-Market step is still building, the per-company buttons are disabled until that finishes — two simultaneous web-search calls against the same backend would slow both. Wait for the company list to finish loading, then click on the companies that matter.

## Working with the company list

A few practical notes for using what Reimagine gives you:

- **The contact information is a starting point, not a guarantee.** Email conventions are inferred from public sources. Verify before you send. A wrong email goes nowhere.
- **The growth signals were current as of the search.** Things change. If a company looks like a great fit, do a quick check on recent news before reaching out.
- **The outreach template is one example.** Use the personalization guide to tailor the email per company. The first paragraph in particular should reference something specific to that company. A talk the executive gave, a recent product launch, a challenge their industry is facing.

## Recruiters for This Path

Directly under Go-to-Market sits a bonus card, **Recruiters for This Path**. Direct outreach reaches the people who own the problem you solve; this card covers the other route in — the executive-search recruiters who fill senior roles in your space.

Click **Find recruiters for this path** and Reimagine researches, live, a short list of search firms that specialize in your function, industry, and level, in two kinds:

- **Boutique / independent firms**, where the firm itself is the specialty. You are pointed at the firm and, where a first-party source confirms one, a specific principal there.
- **Large-firm practices**, where the recommendation is the specific practice and its current named leader, rather than the firm in general.

A person's name is shown only when it traces to a live, checkable source — the firm's own consultant page or the person's own LinkedIn profile. When that cannot be confirmed, the card points you to the practice page instead of guessing a name. Each contact shows where the name came from, a link to reach them, and, when a firm has a relevant search open right now, a green flag with the live listing.

The card also gives you one outreach note you can adapt for each firm, and an **Add more recruiters to your list** panel that works like Find 10 More: get more contacts, or steer the next set toward a focus. A short note at the top explains the difference between retained and contingency search, so you know what to expect when you reach out.

Once the list is built, **Download CSV** saves it as a spreadsheet (firm, tier, contact and title, specialty, links, source, and any search open now) and **Print** sends the list to your printer or a PDF — the same controls the company list has.

This is opt-in and built when you click it, and it is saved with your Focus Playbook. The list starts short on purpose — specialty search is a narrow world, and a short, accurate list beats a padded one.

## When you are happy with it

Click **Update My LinkedIn** to advance to Phase 5: Get Ready, which builds the assets you will need once your outreach starts landing meetings.

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*Next: Phase 5. Get Ready →*

## 9. Getting Ready

These are the sections of your Focus Playbook that get you ready for the conversations the rest of your search creates: networking calls, screening interviews, recruiter messages, the conversation that opens the door. You generate each section on demand from inside the Focus Playbook for any role you are exploring. There is no separate phase to advance through; these sections sit alongside The Role and Your Bridge Story on the same page, and you generate them in the order that fits your week.

**One thing to know up front:** Reimagine does not modify your actual LinkedIn profile or your resume file. It produces the copy and the recommendations. You take that copy and apply the changes yourself. By editing your LinkedIn profile in your browser, and by updating your resume in your own document. There is no integration with LinkedIn and no edit to the file you uploaded. That separation is by design: the changes go on your screen, in your own tools, where you control the final word.

### Industry Background

**What this section does.** Reimagine generates a short briefing on the vocabulary, the tools, and the people who shape the space you are entering. Built from your Personal Brand and the language of this specific role.

**What you will get back.**

- **The 10 essential terms or acronyms** your target space uses, with one-line definitions.
- **The top 3 tools** practitioners rely on, with the context that explains why each one matters.
- **Three thought leaders** to follow on LinkedIn for the perspectives that shape the conversation.
- **The single fastest move** you can make this week to build credibility (an article to read, a podcast to listen to, a conference talk to watch).

**What good looks like.** The terms should be the ones you would hear in a hallway conversation in this industry, not generic business vocabulary. The tools should be specific enough that you could ask an informed question about them on a call. The thought leaders should be people you can follow and learn from.

**How to refine.** Examples:

- "The thought leaders are too well-known. Suggest three people I am less likely to have come across."
- "The terms lean general business. I want terms specific to medical device commercialization."
- "Add a tool for project management; this team uses Asana."

Review Industry Background before networking events, informational calls, and any first conversation where you want to sound like someone who already speaks the language.

### Interview Prep

**What this section does.** The questions this role's interview cycle is most likely to surface, with the raw material from your own inputs to build each answer. The set grounds in the classic questions every candidate should expect — why you are leaving, your strengths and weaknesses, what you know about the company, how you handle conflict, a difficult situation you faced — each one tuned to this role rather than answered generically. The strongest version of each answer is in your voice, with the specifics only you can add.

**What you will get back.**

- **Eight to ten likely questions** for this specific role, with framing recommendations for each.
- **For behavioral questions, a STAR breakdown** (Situation, **Thinking**, Action, Result). The T is for *Thinking*, the most important section. How you diagnosed the problem and chose your path is what hiring managers care about most. Each STAR section pulls from a specific moment in your inputs and includes a "to strengthen" note pointing at what would make the answer land harder.
- **Opening moves** that connect your past experience to the situation the interviewer is facing now. A bridge sentence you can adapt to the company in front of you.
- **A "why this company or role" variant** with talking points pulled from the passions, values, and life experiences you named in Orientation. If those inputs were thin, the talking points flag the gap and ask you to add context about the target company so Reimagine can sharpen the answer.

**STAR Stories live inside Interview Prep.** The strongest stories from your background, structured in STAR form, appear under the behavioral questions they best answer. A "Strengthen This Story" note on each one calls out what details (a number, a budget, a timeline, the framework you used) would make the story stronger if you can recall them. A **Same Story, Different Angle** subsection shows how to shift one strong story for different audiences (a CEO, a CFO, a peer, or a different question entirely).

**Per-story strengthening.** Each story has a textbox below it where you can add details and a **Regenerate Story** button. This regenerates only that one story with your additions folded in, without touching the others. Use it to bake in details Reimagine could not see in your resume.

**What good looks like.** The STAR stories should be drawn from your actual accomplishments, not invented. The Thinking section in each story is the heart of the story. If a Thinking section feels thin, use the per-story regenerate to add the framework or the tradeoff you used.

**How to refine.** Use the main refine box for changes that affect the whole section (different target questions, a different industry focus). Use the per-story regenerate for adjustments to individual stories.

Review Interview Prep before any interview. Review the STAR stories before any conversation that might surface them, and remix them in real time based on who is across the table.

## Resume Refresh

**What this section does.** Reimagine generates a refreshed version of your resume: a repositioned summary, a Key Accomplishments section that pulls your strongest evidence above the fold, the rest of your work history rewritten for relevance to your target, and your education. The recommendations are designed to make the strongest evidence for your target role land in the first seven seconds, which is



the average time a recruiter spends on a first read.

The output arrives in two forms on the same screen:

- **A rendered text view** that shows the full refresh on screen.
- **A Word document** you can download with one click. The downloaded file uses a clean hybrid format: header with your contact line, Summary, Key Accomplishments above the fold, Experience, and Education.

You choose which path fits.

- **Want the finished file?** Click **Download as Word** and the .docx lands in your downloads folder. Open it, polish it if you want, save it under whatever filename you prefer.
- **Want to keep your existing resume's format?** Click **Copy text** and paste the sections you want into your own template. Use as much or as little of the rewrite as fits.

The tool does not edit the file you uploaded. It produces a new Word document and the matching text. The version you came in with was optimized for the role you used to want. The version you take out of this section is optimized for the role you are going after.

#### **What you will get back.**

- **A repositioned summary** at the top of the resume.
- **A Key Accomplishments section** with three to five of your most powerful achievements, reframed as money made, money saved, or risk mitigated, with numbers attached. (If you prefer a different header on your finished resume, Career Highlights, Career Milestones, or Selected Achievements all work.)
- **A rewritten work history** with three to six bullets per role, each starting with an action verb and ending with a business result.
- **Education** carried through from your uploaded resume.

**What good looks like.** The summary should sound like the Personal Brand from Phase 1, written in resume language. The Key Accomplishments bullets should each name a specific outcome with a number. If a bullet describes a duty rather than a result, that is a candidate for refining.

#### **How to refine.** Examples:

- "Lead with my operations experience instead of my product experience."
- "The summary doesn't capture my pivot from finance to product."
- "Add the migration project I led at my second company."

**If the download looks off,** click Regenerate. The output usually lands right the second time. The hint under the buttons points to the same regenerate action that is already on the screen.

## **LinkedIn Remix**

**What this section does.** Reimagine generates suggested updates for your LinkedIn profile: a new headline, a new About section, and reframed experience bullets, all written for the role you are pursuing. You then go into LinkedIn yourself and apply the changes. Reimagine produces the copy. You do the actual update.

**If you uploaded your LinkedIn profile in Orientation,** this section becomes a true refresh. Reimagine references your current profile and recommends specific edits ("your current headline reads X; change it to Y; here is why"). The output is anchored in what you actually have, not generated from scratch. Most users find this version sharper and easier to apply.

**If you skipped the LinkedIn upload,** Reimagine generates recommendations from scratch based on your Personal Brand, Bridge Story, and target direction. The output is still useful; you just have to map it onto your current profile yourself.

LinkedIn is your personal brand on the web, more than an online resume, and how it shows up to recruiters and hiring managers depends almost entirely on the headline and the first three lines of your About section. This section gives you new versions of both, plus a few other recommendations that work together.

#### **What you will get back.**

- **Three headline options.** Each optimizes for something different: search visibility, human resonance, and authority signaling. Each is at most 220 characters, with the most important positioning in the first 50 to 70 characters (the part visible in search results and connection requests).
- **A complete About section** in your voice, first person. The first three lines are designed to grab attention before the "see more" cutoff. The middle tells your story with target keywords woven in. The close states what you are looking for and includes contact info.
- **Target keywords.** Three to five for your role, with guidance on where to place them across your profile.
- **Experience reframe** for your two or three most relevant roles, with bullets that pass the "so what" test.
- **What to do with this profile.** Connection strategy, who to follow, content ideas.

**What good looks like.** The About section should read like you wrote it, not like a recruiter's template. The first three lines should grab a reader who only sees those three lines. The headline you choose should make sense in a connection request. If someone messages you, the headline they see should make them want to respond.

#### **How to refine.** Examples:

- "The headline is too generic. I want it to lead with my industry expertise."
- "The About section opens with my title. I want it to open with the way I described myself in the Bridge Story."
- "Add more keywords for revenue operations roles."

Refine until the copy sounds like you.

**Then take it to LinkedIn.** Once you are happy with the output, copy the headline you chose and paste it into the headline field on your LinkedIn profile. Do the same with the About section, the experience bullets, and the keyword skills. Reimagine has done its part by producing copy you can use; you do the work of putting it on your profile.

## What you walk out with

These four sections, generated inside the Focus Playbook, give you what you need for the conversations the rest of your search creates. A LinkedIn profile that the right people can find. A resume that reads correctly for your target role in seven seconds. The vocabulary and the people who shape the space. The questions you should expect and the stories that answer them. Nothing here is generated in a fixed order; you build the sections you need when you need them.

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*Next: Your Results →*

# 10. Your Results

(Bridge Story structure updated 2026-05-19; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)

When you finish Phase 5, Reimagine takes you to a screen called **Complete**. This is the destination of the journey. Everything you have generated up to this point is gathered here, organized, and made portable.

This chapter walks through what is on that screen and how to use it.

## What you see when you arrive

A short acknowledgment card at the top: "**You finished the foundation.**" Underneath it, the simple recognition that your brand, your bridge story, your target companies, your resume, your LinkedIn, and your playbook are all rooted in who you actually are. That is a substantial amount of career-strategy work.

Below the acknowledgment, three call-out cards in order:

- **Pursuing a specific opportunity?** Points to Add an Opportunity in the sidebar for any role you want a tailored playbook for. (Detailed below.)
- **Career Club's weekly group coaching call.** Free, every Monday at 12:00 ET. Live Q&A on whatever is going on in your job search. Register link inside the card.
- **Go deeper on the methodology.** Reimagine is built on the framework in *Making Your Own Weather* by Bob Goodwin. Link to the book on Amazon.

A small italic line below the three cards mentions Income Now: it turns your existing expertise into consulting or fractional income while you continue the search.

[screenshot: the Complete screen with the acknowledgment header and the three CTA cards]

## The 60-second feedback survey

The first thing under the banner is a short feedback form. Five quick questions:

- How likely are you to recommend Reimagine to someone in career transition? (0 to 10)
- Which part of the process was most valuable to you?
- How has your confidence about your next move changed?
- How well did Reimagine capture who you are and what you bring?
- Anything we should know? What would make this better? (open-ended)

You can submit it, skip it, or fill it out partially. All questions are optional. Whatever you share goes directly to the team building Reimagine. There is no marketing pipeline behind it. Beta feedback is what shapes the next build, and the open-ended question is the most valuable place to surface anything that bugged you, surprised you, or made you wish for something the tool does not yet do.

If you skip the survey, click **No thanks** to dismiss it and continue to your results.

## Your work, organized

Below the survey, every output you generated is shown as its own card. Each card has:

- A title. Your Personal Brand, The Role, Your Bridge Story, Industry Background, Interview Prep, Resume Refresh, LinkedIn Remix, Go-to-Market Strategy, Income Now (if you generated it).
- A **Copy** button that copies the full text of that section to your clipboard.
- A **View** button that takes you to that section's page where you can read it in full and refine it again if you want to.

A header above the section cards names the role: "**Focus Playbook · [Role Name]**." If you explored multiple roles, this header reminds you which Focus Playbook's outputs you are looking at. Your Personal Brand sits above the header as a standalone card because it is constant across every role you explore. Income Now, if you generated it, renders below the seven section cards as a bonus stripe with a slightly demoted card style and a one-line description in place of a content preview.

This is where the journey becomes a working library. Bookmark it. Open it before a coaching call, before an interview, before drafting an email. Each card is one click away from the full output. No need to re-navigate the journey to find what you need.

## How to use what is here

Each output has its own purpose. A short field guide:

- **Your Personal Brand.** Read this before any conversation where someone is going to ask "what do you do." The two-sentence personal brand and the value proposition behind it are the spine of every other answer.
- **The Role.** Read this before any conversation about whether this role is the right fit for you. The rest of the Focus Playbook builds on it, so re-reading the read on the role grounds the harder choices that follow.
- **Your Bridge Story.** Read this aloud before a phone screen or an interview. The goal is to put the three parts (who you are as a human, how that has played out in your career, where you are headed) back into your head, so they are familiar rather than memorized.
- **Industry Background.** Review before networking events, informational calls, and any first conversation in this space. The terms, the tools, and the people you should know to sound like someone already inside the conversation.
- **Interview Prep.** Review before any interview. The STAR stories inside Interview Prep are worth reading before any conversation that might surface them, and worth remixing in real time based on who is across the table. The Same Story Different Angle subsection is the practice ground for that remixing.

- **Resume Refresh.** Open your resume document and apply the changes. The summary, the career highlights, the role expansion and compression guidance, and a Skills section built from the skills you validated, so the resume carries the keywords an applicant tracking system scans for. Your strongest wins appear both in the Career Highlights block up top and under the jobs where they happened, written from two different angles so they read as evidence rather than repetition. Download it as a recruiter-facing Human version or an ATS version for online applications (see below).
- **LinkedIn Remix.** Copy the headline you chose into LinkedIn. Copy the About section. Apply the experience reframes. The output stays here for reference; the work happens in your LinkedIn profile.
- **Go-to-Market Strategy.** Your operating manual for the search itself. The hiring executive profile tells you who to reach. The target company list tells you where. The outreach template is your starting draft, personalized per company. (Don't forget: the **Download CSV** button on the Phase 4 screen pulls the company list out as a working spreadsheet. Open it in Excel, Google Sheets, or Numbers and run your search from it. Add columns as you go: when you reached out, who you reached out to, what you heard back, what the next step is.)
- **Income Now.** Your fastest path to revenue while you search, if you generated it. Renders as a bonus stripe below the seven section cards on Complete, with a slimmer card body and a one-line description in place of a preview snippet.

## Your Career Highlights and your resume body work together

Your three to five strongest wins sit in a Career Highlights block at the top of the resume, chosen for the direction you are targeting. Those same wins also belong under the jobs where they happened. Reimagine does not repeat them word for word in both places, and that is deliberate.

A hiring manager reads top to bottom. They meet the Highlight first, then the role below it. If the two said the same thing twice, the second reading would feel like filler. So the Highlight up top carries the headline result in its most compressed form, and the bullet under the job carries the part the Highlight left out: how you did it, the scope you did it at, and the supporting numbers. Same accomplishment, seen from two angles. The version under the job becomes the evidence for the claim at the top, which is exactly what a careful reader is looking for.

When a win is a single number with no story behind it, Reimagine keeps it in the Career Highlights only and gives the job a different bullet, so nothing reads as a reworded copy. The result is a resume that rewards a second read instead of repeating itself.

## Two versions: one for a person, one for the software

Some applications go to a person first. Many go through applicant tracking software (names you may see: Workday, Greenhouse, iCIMS) that reads your resume into fields and scores it for keywords before any human sees it. The two readers reward different things, so Resume Refresh gives you both from the same content, behind a simple toggle above the resume preview.

The **Human version** is tuned for the recruiter: your strongest wins in a Career Highlights block up top, bold drawing the eye, a polished layout. Use it for a referral, a direct hand-off, or walking into an interview.

The **ATS version** is tuned for the software: your skills promoted to a Core Competencies list near the top where the parser weights them, standard section headings the software recognizes, and plain type that parses cleanly. Your strongest wins are placed inside the roles where they happened, so the keywords sit in the context the software scores rather than in a separate block it may skip. Use it when you apply through a company's online portal.

Nothing is invented for either one. Every number, employer, and date is identical. The ATS version simply re-arranges the same true record for the machine reader, and the download follows whichever version you have selected.

## Held several roles at one company? Reimagine groups them

If you were promoted or changed roles at the same employer, Resume Refresh keeps that employer as a single block. The company name appears once, and each role you held sits below it with its own dates, most recent first. Your accomplishments sit directly under the role where you earned them, so a reader sees not just that you were promoted but what you delivered at each level. A reader sees the progression at a glance, and it never reads as if you left and came back. If you held just one role at a company, it renders as a single title and date line, the way you would expect.

## Your progress is saved across devices

A banner reminds you that your work is saved against your account. As long as you are signed in, your progress travels with you across devices. Chapter 13 covers the details of how account-based saving works, plus the export options for backups and snapshots.

When you finish the main flow and land on Complete, the progress bar in the header reads 100%.

## Pursuing a specific opportunity

The first CTA card on the Complete screen invites you to bring a job description into Reimagine. When a posting catches your eye (through your network, on LinkedIn, in a posting you came across yourself), head to **Add an Opportunity** in the sidebar. Paste the description or upload the PDF. Reimagine creates an Opportunity Playbook scoped to that role with four sections you can build on demand: The Role, Bridge Story, Resume Refresh, and Interview Prep. Chapter 11b walks through the module in detail.

This is the most natural reason to come back to Reimagine during an active search. Every specific role you consider can get its own playbook.

## Join the weekly coaching call

The second CTA card on the Complete screen points to Career Club's weekly group coaching call. Free, every Monday at 12:00 ET, live Q&A on whatever is going on in your job search. The card

includes a registration link.

The call is open to anyone who has used Reimagine. Bring a question, listen to other people work through theirs, or just sit in and learn how other senior professionals are navigating the same search.

## Go deeper with Making Your Own Weather

The third CTA card points to *Making Your Own Weather*, the book by Bob Goodwin that the Reimagine methodology is built on. If anything in the journey resonated and you want the framework spelled out in long form (the philosophy, the structure, the worked examples), the book is the source. Link to Amazon inside the card.

## The Income Now mention

A small italic line below the three CTA cards mentions Income Now: it turns your existing expertise into consulting or fractional income while you continue the search. For some people the bridge becomes the path.

If you have not yet generated Income Now, click into it from the sidebar (or the dedicated "Income Now" entry). Chapter 11 covers what it produces.

If you have already generated Income Now, the result appears as a card in your regular results list.

## Your Deliverables

Near the bottom of the screen, a section labeled **Your Deliverables**. Three buttons:

- **Download One-Pager (PDF)**. The clean printable summary of your work. Includes your personal brand, your value proposition, your bridge story, and your target direction. It is designed to be readable in 60 seconds. Use it to share your story with a recruiter, a coach, or a contact in your network you would like to refer you. The same button is also in the banner at the top of the screen.
- **Download All Outputs as Markdown**. The complete record of every generated section, in one markdown file you can open in any text editor or convert to PDF. Useful when you want a working document of everything Reimagine produced for you to reference offline.
- **Start a New Session**. Resets everything and takes you back to the welcome screen. Use this if you want to run a fresh full journey from scratch. For example, with a different professional identity. Be careful: it clears your saved progress. If you want to keep the current session, download the markdown first.

## Turn your one-pager into a podcast about you

Here is one of the more interesting things users do with the PDF, and it is more useful than it sounds. Upload your one-pager into **Notebook LM** (Google's free notebook tool at [notebooklm.google.com](https://notebooklm.google.com)) and use the **Audio Summary** feature. Notebook LM generates a short podcast-style conversation between two hosts who read the document, react to your background, and discuss your value proposition out loud.



It is a little bit fun. It is also surprisingly useful. There is something about hearing someone else talk about you that is validating in ways reading the same words on a page cannot match. When the hosts react to a specific accomplishment, or call out something that makes your combination distinctive, you get an unexpected outside perspective on the brand you just built. That perspective tends to land in a way that paper does not.

A few minutes to set up. A few minutes of audio to listen back. The effect tends to be grounding, often surprisingly so. The moment Reimagine's output stops being words on a page and starts feeling like a story you can carry into a conversation.

## How to come back to your results

Sign in from any device with the same email you used originally. Your work loads automatically and you land back on the Complete screen.

Some users come back to the Complete screen daily during an active search. Others come back weekly. The point is that the destination is stable: every output you generated is here, every section is one click away, and the deliverables you need to actually run your search live in the same place.

## When to come back to refine

Even after you reach the Complete screen, the journey is not closed. If you have a conversation that surfaces something new. A project you forgot to mention, a passion you should have flagged, a refined direction. You can navigate back to the relevant step in the sidebar, refine your input, and regenerate from there. Chapter 12 covers the mechanics. The Complete screen is the destination, not the end.

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*Next: Bonus. Income Now →*

# 11. Bonus. Income Now

*Where this lives now.* Income Now is the bonus section that lives below the seven main sections inside the Focus Playbook for a specific role (Chapter 6). It generates separately and renders with bonus-stripe treatment on both the Focus Playbook page and the Complete page. You can reach it from inside the Focus Playbook, and from the Income Now item nested under Put It to Work in the left sidebar. If you open it from the sidebar before picking a direction, you'll see a short screen that points you to Career Paths first, since the plan is built around the direction you choose. Everything below still describes what it produces and how to use it.

When money gets tight, the temptation is to take whatever pays the bills. Reimagine has a different idea.

Income Now turns the same expertise that makes you valuable for a permanent role into income you can start generating right now: consulting, gig work, fractional engagements. Real money, from your real skills, while you keep searching for the right full-time fit.

## More than bridge income

Income Now is most often used as a bridge to keep income flowing during a search. It also does several other things just as well:

- **A foot in the door.** A fractional engagement often turns into a permanent role at the same company once they see what you bring.
- **A path you did not see coming.** Some people start fractional work because they need income and discover it is what they actually want to be doing.
- **A credential-builder.** Six months of consulting in a new sector can be the experience that qualifies you for the full-time role you originally wanted.

Use it for any of those reasons, or all of them.

## When to use it

If a job search is going to take longer than your runway, having income flowing changes the dynamic completely. You make better decisions when you are choosing rather than settling. Even if you are not in financial pressure, keeping one foot in active work (through consulting, advisory, fractional engagements) often shapes what your next permanent chapter ends up being.

## What this module does

Reimagine builds a complete fractional and consulting plan tailored to your background, your seniority, and the focus you chose at the end of Phase 2. The plan has six parts:

- **Where to show up.** Four to six marketplaces and platforms (Catalant, Toptal, Bolste, Business Talent Group, etc.) matched to your function, with realistic rate ranges and the first step to get listed on each.

- **Your consulting presence.** A positioning headline, a 150-word bio, four specific service offerings (each with a problem-first title, the buyer, the deliverable, the outcome, and a price), and a complete outreach message you can send to your network.
- **A fractional pitch.** A one-paragraph cold outreach for LinkedIn or email.
- **Passion-adjacent opportunities.** Three engagements at the intersection of your professional skills and your stated passions that could generate income within 60 days.
- **A one-sheet.** A problem-first one-page document you can share with prospects.
- **Your first 48 hours.** Exactly what to do in the next two days to have a profile live or an outreach message sent.

## How to find it

You can access Income Now in two places:

- **From the sidebar.** Income Now appears in the left sidebar nested under Put It to Work, reachable once you have picked a direction and built your Focus Playbook. When you generate it, the sidebar entry gets a checkmark like every other completed step.
- **From the Results page.** When you reach the **Complete** screen at the end of the main journey, there is a callout for Income Now with a **Generate My Income Plan** button.

## On the screen

The Income Now entry screen opens with the same framing this chapter does: "When money gets tight, the temptation is to take whatever pays the bills" plus the four value paths. Read it, then click **Build My Income Plan** to generate. This is the most thorough generation in the tool: expect three to four minutes.

## What good looks like

The platform recommendations should match your function. If you are an HR executive, you should see Catalant, Business Talent Group, Bolste. If you are a finance executive, you should see Toptal Finance, Graphite, the CFO Alliance. If the platforms feel off-target, refine.

The service offerings should be problem-first, not seller-first. A title like "When your best people are leaving and you don't know why" is doing its job. A title like "Retention Consulting" is generic. Refine it.

The rates should match your seniority. The standard ranges Reimagine uses are roughly \$300–\$500/hour for advisory work, \$1,000–\$3,000 for a defined deliverable, and \$4,000–\$10,000 for a strategic engagement. If your market is materially different (lower-cost geography, very specialized expertise, etc.), refine with that context.

## Compensation Read

Below your income plan, Income Now carries a **Compensation Read**: a sourced pay range for the direction you picked, in your market. Click **Build** and Reimagine searches public salary sites (Glassdoor, BuiltIn, Salary.com, PayScale, and similar), triangulates two or three of them, and reports the range with every dollar figure a clickable link to its source so you can check it yourself. It sets aside sources that are matching a mislabeled version of the role, so a stray high or low outlier doesn't distort the range. Because the relevant public sources still disagree among themselves, it names the honest spread rather than one falsely precise number. A disclaimer under the card says what it is: a starting point for your own research, not a verdict. It is context for the direction you are weighing, never a signal for whether to pursue it — that call stays yours. (The same Compensation Read appears inside an Opportunity Playbook for a specific posting, where it also feeds an Offer & Negotiation section; see Chapter 11b.)

## How to refine

Examples:

- "I want more consulting options and fewer platform-based ideas."
- "Adjust rates for my geography. I'm in a lower-cost market."
- "I have existing clients I can leverage. Build the plan around starting with them."
- "Focus on board work and advisory rather than hands-on engagement."

Use **Update my plan** to fold the changes in. Use **Show me a fresh plan** to clear and start over.

## When you are happy with it

When you finish Income Now, click **Back to Results** to return to the Complete screen. Your Income Now plan is now part of your library of outputs there, alongside everything else you generated in the main journey. Treat it the same way: come back to it whenever you have a conversation that should be a paid one, or when you want to update your rates, your bio, or your service offerings. Chapter 12 covers how to refine and regenerate any output you have already produced.

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*Next: Refining and Regenerating Your Results →*

## 11b. Add an Opportunity

*(Bridge Story structure updated 2026-05-19; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)*

This is the **Add an Opportunity** card on the Put It to Work screen in Phase 2 (Chapter 6). Whenever you have a specific job description in hand, choose Add an Opportunity, paste it in, and Reimagine creates an Opportunity Playbook for that role with five sections. Two of them start building the moment you submit the posting; the rest you build on demand. It is the most natural reason to come back to Reimagine during an active search: every specific role you consider can get its own playbook here. You no longer have to finish the main journey first; Add an Opportunity is available as soon as you reach the Put It to Work screen, and the sidebar entry under Phase 2 routes back there from anywhere in the app.

### When to use it

The full Reimagine journey gives you a strategy. Who you are, where you fit, three directions through your possible options, a chosen target, a bridge story, a target company list, refreshed LinkedIn and resume, and a Focus Playbook.

That strategy gets you ready to act. Specific roles come into view: a posting your network forwarded you, a job description you found on LinkedIn, an opportunity you uncovered through your outreach. When one of those lands in your sights and you want to be sharp for it, this module gives you five sections you can build for that exact role.

Use it when:

- You are seriously considering applying to a specific posting
- You have a screening call or first conversation scheduled
- You want to know whether a role is the right fit before you invest more time in it
- You want a Bridge Story or interview prep tuned to this specific posting

### What this module produces

You paste a job description or upload it as a PDF. Reimagine creates an Opportunity Playbook scoped to that role with seven sections. Three of them — About This Company, Compensation, and The Role — start building the moment you submit the posting, because they need nothing from you beyond the JD itself. The rest you build when you want them. Every section is saved with this opportunity:

- **The Role** — an honest read on alignment with the direction you are pursuing, where the role stretches you, and the watch-outs you should know going in. It finishes with a **30-second bridge story** tuned to this posting — the case above in words you can say out loud. The bridge builds automatically right after the read, and you can refine it in its own feedback box until it sounds like you saying it.

- **Resume Refresh** — a repositioned summary and key accomplishments that emphasize the competencies this role asks for.
- **Cover Letter** — a short draft letter tuned to this posting, in your own voice. It is the sibling of your Go-to-Market outreach: the same direct, human energy, adapted for when you are responding to a posting. It is part of your application packet with your bridge story (built into The Role) and Resume Refresh, tuned so they read as one voice rather than repeating each other. It draws on those two, so building them first makes the letter stronger (it will still generate without them). It addresses the company by name, so it needs a posting Reimagine can identify the company from. Drawing on your About This Company research, it opens to the most relevant leader by first name when the research names one whose area covers the role, and to the team by function otherwise (no "Dear Hiring Manager").
- **Interview Prep** — the questions this role's interview cycle is most likely to ask, each with a structured answer (STAR) drawn from your own experience.
- **About This Company** — a read on the company beyond what you would find on Glassdoor: news from the last 90 days, the employee voice, the leadership's public footprint, and watch-outs named honestly, with industry-specific signal (a hospital's CMS Star Rating, a pharma's FDA actions, a nonprofit's 990 filings, and similar) woven in where it bears on your decision — in the market read, or as a watch-out. Every numeric or named factual claim cites its source URL inline; the card uses live web search. The **View job description** link in the section rail keeps the posting you submitted retrievable at any time, read-only, in exactly the text Reimagine built the playbook from (lightly cleaned up for reading). Note that Reimagine keeps that text, not the original file — an uploaded PDF is read into text on submission and the file itself is not stored, so what comes back is the posting's words, not a formatted document.
- **Compensation Read** — a sourced pay range for this role and market, triangulated across public salary sites (Glassdoor, BuiltIn, Salary.com, PayScale, and similar), with every dollar figure a clickable link to its source so you can check it yourself. On an Opportunity it looks up the company's size from public sources (the employee band on its LinkedIn page, and similar) and opens the read by naming the basis it anchored to — the company's size, the industry, and the market — since company size moves senior-role pay a lot. It sets aside sources that are matching a mislabeled version of the role (for example, manager-level pay showing up under a chief-officer title) so a stray outlier doesn't distort the range. For a senior or C-suite officer role at a sizable or prominent organization, it does more than screen outliers: generic salary sites systematically under-price officers (they pool the title with far-smaller employers), so the read reaches instead for the sources that actually price officers — IRS Form 990 officer-compensation filings for a nonprofit and its peers, SEC proxy statements (DEF 14A) for a public company — and anchors on that peer set. Where only generic data exists, it reports it but labels it a floor for that seniority, not the market rate. If it got the basis wrong, a "Did we get this wrong?" box under the card lets you correct the size, industry, or market, and it rebuilds the estimate against what you tell it. The relevant public sources still disagree among themselves, so the card names the honest spread across them rather than one falsely precise number, and it uses live web search. It is a starting point for your own research, not a verdict — a disclaimer under the card says exactly that. Build it when you want it.

- Offer & Negotiation** — built on your Compensation Read, and written the way a seasoned executive compensation advisor would: where the offer sits against the *right* benchmark (for a senior or officer role, the employer's or peers' actual officer pay from public filings when the About This Company read surfaced it, not just a generic range), what to ask for, how it lines up with the practical priorities you set in Orientation, and the full package quantified. It reads the offer holistically — in trade-offs, not in isolation — the way an advisor would talk you through it. It gives you the package in totality (the firm money you can bank on versus the at-risk upside), then surfaces every trade-off that will shape your decision — as many as the offer presents, not a fixed few — such as trading a one-time sign-on for base that compounds into every future raise; how much equity or bonus risk to carry given your stability-vs-upside lean; or whether the money offsets a term that cuts against a priority you named, like travel — each framed as what you'd gain, what you'd give up, and what the call hinges on, never a verdict. The asks that follow are a sequenced plan (lead with the strongest, and what to pivot to if it's held), each carrying the specific target and the exact sentence you can say — and the case is built *forward*: the argument for more is the value you'll create for **this** employer (money you'll make or save, risk you'll reduce), with a past win used only as proof you can deliver it, never as the whole argument. Because you know your intended impact better than we can infer it, a **Strengthen your case** box lets you add, in your own words, anything that backs your asks — the value you'll create here, unvested equity you're forfeiting to leave (grounds for a make-whole sign-on), a real cost the move imposes like a longer commute, or a competing offer — and on rebuild the analysis builds each ask on it. And because the puts and takes are a conversation, a **Talk through the trade-offs with My Coach** button hands you off to your coach — who holds the same offer, priorities, and reasoning — to work them one at a time and help you land where it's right for *you*. It also states your real first-year and steady-state total compensation in dollars, rather than pointing you at a checklist. The case is always evidence — the return your work produced, tied to the number, never "you deserve more" as an assertion. Every deal point is data-backed rather than a want (the *Making Your Own Weather* way): where a sourced figure exists it's cited with a link you can click, and for the components we don't have a number for — a sign-on, an equity term, PTO, severance — the analysis points you to the authoritative source you can pull it from (Levels.fyi and executive-comp surveys, the employer's 990 or proxy filing, SHRM or BLS benefits data), so you walk in with evidence for each point, not an ask. You can give it your offer two ways: type a quick number in the optional field, or **upload the actual offer letter** (PDF, Word, or paste the text) and Reimagine breaks it into its parts — base, bonus, equity, sign-on, benefits, PTO, start date, contingencies, and more — into an editable list you can correct. That list is collapsed by default behind a **What we found in your offer** twisty — it's mainly there to confirm we parsed the terms right, so it stays out of the way until you open it. Blank fields are terms the letter didn't mention, which are often the best things to ask about. If we misread a field, edit it in place; there's no need to start over. When the company comes back with a better letter after you negotiate, use **Upload an updated offer** to replace the terms — it re-runs your guidance on the new numbers and shows you **what changed since your previous offer** (base, sign-on, equity, and your first-year total, each with the difference), so the result of your negotiation is right in front of you. Reimagine reads only the compensation and employment terms — never Social Security numbers, bank details, or your home address — and it does not keep the document; only the parsed terms are saved to your account. The parsed offer feeds the guidance in place of a typed number. When you upload or paste a new

letter, Reimagine refreshes the Offer & Negotiation guidance off the new terms on its own — you don't rebuild it by hand — so what you see always reflects the latest offer. (The Compensation Read isn't re-run; it's market data for the role and company, and your offer doesn't change it.) A **Price your benefits** panel lets you add a few optional numbers focused on what actually moves your take-home: your monthly health premium (what comes out of your check), the 401(k) match, any employer HSA contribution, and PTO days. When you upload an offer letter, the fields the letter states — the 401(k) match, employer HSA, deductible, and a plain PTO day count — are filled in from it, so you're mostly confirming rather than re-typing. The letter is the source of truth for those, so uploading an updated letter refreshes them to the new numbers, overwriting an earlier value. The one number the letter usually doesn't carry — your own monthly health premium — is never touched, and a PTO stated as "Unlimited" leaves your own estimate alone. Enter each the way the offer states it — the 401(k) match as a percent of base (say "3%") is fine, and Reimagine converts it to dollars against your base rather than reading it as three dollars. Once you've entered a number or two, press **Calculate** and the panel shows what these benefits are worth to you per year, net of what you pay for health, plus your first-year total. The comparison later weighs the money that comes back to you against what you pay for health — so an offer with a higher salary but a costlier plan doesn't look better than it is. It's entirely optional; anything you skip simply isn't counted. A **Model your bonus** control sits alongside it: set the attainment you actually expect (for a percent-of-base bonus) or a dollar figure (for a dollar or commission bonus) and press Calculate to see the payout at that level. A target is the optimistic case, so the bonus is kept separate from the firm number rather than baked into it — the honest figure to lean on is what you can bank on without the bonus. If the offer includes equity, a **How to read the equity** panel sets the company stage (public, late-stage private, early-stage private) and frames it honestly — a private grant sits behind investors and can be worth nothing, so it's deliberately held out of every total and left as a personal call to weigh with your Coach. The analysis also includes a **How it fits what matters to you** read — it measures the offer against the practical non-negotiables you set in the Your Priorities & Non-Negotiables step of Orientation (your compensation floor, commute or remote needs, deal-breakers, and stability-vs-upside lean) and flags conflicts (a base under your floor, a hybrid role when you need remote, a deal-breaker the offer appears to hit) as things to confirm before you decide. This part is a fit read, never a verdict — it never tells you whether to accept; that call is yours. (It only appears when you've set priorities.) Once the analysis is built, a **Prepare for the conversation** button condenses it into a printable set of **talking points** — what to confirm before you decide, what to ask for (each with the one line to say), and what to get in writing — that you can take into the conversation or paste into a follow-up. Once you've built them, they refresh on their own whenever the analysis is rebuilt — after you upload an updated offer letter, say — so they never fall out of sync with the deal. A **Print / Save as PDF** button opens it as a clean, one-page Reimagine document. The card also carries two things you can use straight away without generating anything: a **total compensation checklist** (bonus payout history, benefits detail, equity, PTO utilization, and more) and a short **negotiation script library**. For the offer situations that don't have a universal answer — severance timing, take-it-or-leave-it or algorithm-set offers, reading a company's layoff history — it points you to a real conversation with My Coach. It only names market figures your Compensation Read already sourced, so build that first. Whether to accept is always your call.



Each section is independent. About This Company, Compensation, and The Role are already underway from the moment you submit; for the others, build the ones that help most for the role you care about and leave the rest. A section rail on the left of the page lists the sections; each entry shows a check once it is built, so you can see your progress at a glance. Click any entry to jump to it.

## How to find it

After you complete the main journey, **Add an Opportunity** appears in the sidebar below Income Now. The Complete screen also includes a callout pointing here.

Until you finish Complete, the sidebar entry is dimmed and not clickable. The module is built on everything you produce in the main flow, so it cannot be used until that foundation is in place.

## On the screen

The intro screen explains what the module is for. A small **What to bring** callout reminds you that Reimagine works best with the actual posting text (not a summary), and that adding your own context about the role makes the playbook sharper. If you know who told you about the role, what they said about the team, why you are interested, or anything about your relationship to the hiring manager, add it to the text field alongside the JD.

Below the intro:

- An option to upload a PDF of the job description
- A divider
- A textarea where you can paste the job description text instead

You can use either. If you upload a PDF, Reimagine extracts the text and shows it in the textarea so you can edit before generating. If you paste, the text goes straight into the textarea.

Each time you add an opportunity, the form starts empty, so you are always pasting a fresh posting rather than editing a prior one. Your existing opportunities stay saved in My Playbooks; adding a new one never replaces them.

When you have the JD in place, click **Build My Playbook**. Reimagine creates the opportunity record and lands you on the playbook within about a second, then immediately starts building your first cards for you, from the top down. About This Company comes first: it gathers industry context, recent moves, and how this company tends to evaluate candidates. Compensation follows with a sourced pay range for the role and market. Then The Role, a quick read on what the posting is asking for. A short line at the top tells you what is building and what is coming, and each card appears as it finishes. The other cards (Resume Refresh, Cover Letter, and Interview Prep) wait for you to choose what to build next. About This Company and Compensation run live web search, so they take a little longer; The Role lands in about half a minute once it starts. The saved playbook is titled from the posting itself — the company and the role — a moment after you submit, and you can rename it any time from My Playbooks.

## What good looks like

- **The Role should be honest, not flattering.** If the role is off-path from what you chose in Phase 2, the section should say so plainly and explain why. Reimagine coaches; it does not gatekeep. The decision to pursue is yours.
- **The bridge story should sound like you saying it out loud.** It is the finishing beat of The Role: a draft you refine into a 30-second answer you can deliver in a screening call without sounding memorized.
- **The Resume Refresh should foreground the competencies this role asks for.** The repositioned summary and the strongest accomplishments shift; the rest of your resume can stay as it is.
- **Address the cover letter to the most relevant leader, by first name.** Reimagine reads your About This Company research and opens the letter to the executive whose area covers the role — first name only, no "Dear" and no title. When no clear person fits (relevance matters more than seniority, so it will not just grab the CEO), it addresses the team by function ("Hi Product Team,") rather than "Dear Hiring Manager." Build About This Company first so the letter has a name to work with.
- **Interview Prep should give you the actual questions this role's interview cycle will ask,** with the raw material from your own inputs to build each answer. The strongest version is in your voice, with the specifics only you can add.
- **About This Company should surface one or two findings you would not have thought to look for.** Industry-specific signal is woven in where it bears on your decision — a hospital's CMS Star Rating and Leapfrog Safety Grade, a pharma's FDA actions — surfacing in the market read, or as a named watch-out when it is a concern. Every numeric claim cites a source URL inline. Watch-outs are named plainly, not softened.

## How to refine

Each section has its own Refine box. Examples:

- "You missed that the role explicitly requires P&L experience. Emphasize that more."
- "My time at [Company] was internal strategy, not consulting. Recast The Role with that in mind."
- "The STAR stories are too leadership-heavy. The role is more individual contributor. Pick stories that show that."
- "The Resume Refresh skews too marketing-flavored. The role is more operations; rework the accomplishments to match."

Use the Refine box on the section you want to change. The corrections you submit persist on your profile and propagate to any later Focus Playbooks or Opportunity Playbooks you build for other roles, just like factual corrections elsewhere in the tool (Chapter 12 covers this in detail).

## Saved with each opportunity

Each opportunity is saved on its own, with whichever sections you have built. You can come back to it later and find it where you left it, and you can work several opportunities at once without one replacing another. In My Playbooks, your opportunities appear together under **Opportunity Playbooks**, listed separately from your direction-level **Focus Playbooks**. The section count on each card ("2 of 4 sections built") shows you at a glance how far along that opportunity is.

When you have logged an offer on two or more opportunities, a **Compare offers** button appears in My Playbooks. It lines the offers up side by side around a "cash and benefits you can bank on" line — base pay, plus the benefits that come back to you (401(k) match, HSA, PTO), minus what you pay for health. That's the firm money, so an offer with a higher salary but a costlier health plan doesn't look better than it is; two offers a few thousand dollars apart in salary can flip once the premium is counted. Bonus and equity sit on their own lines below, since what they're really worth depends on attainment and on an exit no one can predict — the bonus line shows the payout at the attainment level you modeled, with a separate "with bonus, if you hit it" line so you can see the difference without treating it as guaranteed. Equity is held at \$0 in every total, with its stage and any paper value noted beside it — a private grant can be worth nothing, so counting it would flatter the offer. Anything you didn't price shows as "not counted," and the comparison never ranks the offers or tells you which to take; it just puts the full picture in front of you.

Opportunities you saved before this update keep their original shape: the full ten-section playbook, exactly as you built it, with its own Refine box. Nothing you did is lost. New opportunities you start from here use the five-section shape described above. If you want the five-section shape for an older opportunity, paste its job description again through Add an Opportunity and build the sections you need.

## Save as PDF

When the playbook is complete, Save as PDF builds a polished single-document version you can keep, share, or come back to. The persistent gold footer button appears as soon as one card is built, and an inline cue appears at the bottom of the cards once all five are done. The output is a clean, paged PDF with each section on its own page.

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*Next: Refining and Regenerating Your Results →*

## 11c. My Coach

My Coach is a coach you can ask anything about your job search, any time. What makes it different from a general AI chatbot is that it already knows you — it has read your Reimagine profile, your Personal Brand, your resume, and the work you've built here, so its answers are about your situation, not generic advice. It's grounded in the same method the rest of Reimagine is built on, Bob Goodwin's Making Your Own Weather.

Ask it the tactical questions (how to open a networking conversation, how to follow up after an interview, where to find smaller companies worth pursuing) and the human ones (a rejection that stung, a Monday when the search feels heavy). It's built to meet both.

### How to find it

A few ways in, one conversation: the chat button in the corner of every screen once you're signed in; My Coach in the sidebar, there from your very first screen in orientation; and an **Ask My Coach about this** button on each section you build — your Personal Brand and every part of your playbook — which opens the coach with a question about that section ready for you to send or edit. Along the way you'll also see quieter prompts at the spots where people tend to pause — "Not sure what to write?" on the orientation questions, a nudge to talk through which direction fits you, a heads-up on a section before you build it — each one opening the coach with the right question already framed. Your history follows you across all of them.

### What it can do

Answer questions about any part of your search, grounded in what it knows about you; reflect your real experience back to you; and point you to the right Reimagine step when one fits.

### What it won't do, and why that helps

It won't change your work — it's read-only, and points you to the step when something needs updating. It won't invent market data or quote your odds. And it's a coach, not a therapist; if you're carrying something heavier than an ordinary hard day, it will gently point you toward a real person.

### Getting the most from it

It's sharpest once your profile is built. Ask real, specific questions. And bring the hard parts too — the mindset side of a search is part of what it's for.

## 11d. Negotiating an Offer

Most of what you need to negotiate well is stable enough to write down once. The Offer & Negotiation section in your Opportunity Playbook carries it: a sourced pay range for the role, a total compensation checklist so you ask about the whole package and not just base, and a few scripts that do a lot of work in the conversation. Build the Compensation Read, enter your offer if you have one, and you have the number, the range it sits against, and the language to open the conversation.

But some of the hardest questions in a negotiation don't have a universal answer. They depend on the company, the moment, and your own read of the situation. Those belong in a conversation with My Coach, which knows your profile and can reason about your specific case. This chapter covers the ones that come up most, so you know what to bring to that conversation.

### The number, framed as evidence, not entitlement

The strongest ask rests on evidence. Rather than claiming you deserve more, you show what you did, the return it produced, and the number that reflects it. Your Offer & Negotiation section already builds this for you — it pulls a concrete accomplishment from the work you did in Bridge Story and Interview Prep and ties it to the number. Confidence in a negotiation comes from evidence you can point to, not from asserting your worth. When you walk in with the proof, you don't have to claim the value; the value is already on the table.

### Negotiating severance before you accept

This one depends on the specifics. Asking about severance terms before you've accepted an offer is uncommon, and how a company reacts to the question tends to track its size and maturity — a larger, more established employer is more likely to have a framework for it and to take the question in stride than a small company where the concept may not exist. It is not a reason to hold back if the security matters to you, but go in knowing it is a less-traveled ask, and let the size and formality of the employer shape how you raise it. My Coach can help you think through whether and how to bring it up for your specific situation.

### Reading a company's stability before you push

How hard you push is partly a read on the company itself. Recent layoffs, a shaky funding position, or a market under pressure change the leverage on both sides. The goal is to calibrate the ask to what you can see, sizing the push to the moment rather than walking away from it. Public signal helps here: the About This Company section gathers recent news, and you can bring what you find to My Coach to think through what it means for your negotiation.

### Offers with no room to negotiate

Some offers are set by an algorithm or a rigid band with no discretion at the table, and you'll sometimes be told directly that the number is the number. When that's real, the useful move is a clear read on the labor market and your own leverage — a better script won't move a fixed number. Look at how

in-demand the skill set is, how replaceable the role is, and whether there's a non-cash lever (title, start date, remote terms, a review timeline) even when base is fixed. My Coach can help you find the lever that actually exists in a situation like this rather than pushing on one that doesn't.

## **Who you're actually talking to**

Who you negotiate with shapes what's possible. A recruiter or HR contact is often relaying a range they don't own; the hiring manager is usually the person who actually wants you and has more room to advocate internally. It's worth knowing which conversation you're in, and when it makes sense to move the compensation conversation toward the person with the most stake in bringing you on. This is a judgment call about your specific situation — a good one to talk through with My Coach.

## **The through-line**

Static content owns the stable half of negotiating: the checklist, the scripts, the sourced number. This chapter and My Coach own the half that's a judgment call. Reimagine won't tell you which offer to take or hand you a single right answer to a situational question — the decision is always yours. What it does is put the full picture on the table and give you a place to reason through the parts that don't fit a script.

# 11e. How an Offer Is Put Together

An offer is more than a base salary, and the parts that aren't base are where the real value, and the real traps, hide. This chapter is the anatomy: every element that can show up in a white-collar offer, what each one is worth, and the question to ask about each. Reimagine's Offer & Negotiation section uses this same logic to price the stable parts, and My Coach draws on it to reason about your specific situation. Figures dated 2026 are IRS or legal limits current for that year; they move, so confirm the current number when it matters.

## The cash

**Base salary** is the only fully guaranteed, non-probabilistic number in the whole offer, so it anchors everything else. Geographic pay zones are real: some employers (GitLab publishes its formula; Google and Meta use metro zones) can pay six figures differently for the identical level by location. Ask which pay zone applies to your address, whether it is locked at hire, and what happens if you relocate later — many employers adjust base down on a move to a lower-cost area. If a range was posted (about ten states and several cities now require it), ask where your offer lands in it and why.

**Sign-on bonuses** are usually one-time and almost always carry a clawback: repay some or all if you leave within a window, commonly 12 months. Taxed as supplemental wages at a flat 22% withholding (which is a withholding rate, not your final tax). Ask the exact clawback window and the proration math, whether a layoff excuses repayment, and whether what you'd owe back is gross or net of the tax already withheld — that last one is a frequent and expensive surprise.

**Annual bonuses** come in three flavors: guaranteed (contractually owed, common as a first-year make-whole), target (a percentage of base at full attainment, not guaranteed), and discretionary (no formula). The near-universal trap is an "active employment on the payout date" clause: a fully earned bonus can be forfeited by leaving before the check is cut, usually in Q1 of the next year. Ask the target percentage, whether year one is guaranteed, the historical company-multiplier range, and the exact payout date and its forfeiture condition.

**Commission plans** quote OTE (on-target earnings) = base + variable at full attainment, which is a target, not a promise. Watch the base/variable mix, the quota-setting method, and draws: a recoverable draw is an advance you repay if commissions don't cover it; a non-recoverable draw is a floor. Ask for quota and territory in writing before signing, the draw type and what happens to an unrecovered balance at termination, and the churn-clawback window (commission reversed if a deal is refunded or churns).

The question that runs across all of cash comp: what exact event triggers forfeiture, and what is the exact date and condition for payment. The gap between "earned" and "paid" is where most disputes start.

## The equity

**RSUs** vest over four years with a one-year cliff, with refresh grants layered in from year two or three. They are taxed as ordinary income at each vesting date on the value then, not at grant. Public

companies use single-trigger vesting (time alone settles the grant); private companies typically use double-trigger (time plus a liquidity event like an IPO or acquisition), which protects you from owing tax on stock you can't sell but means leaving before that event can forfeit otherwise time-vested shares. Unvested RSUs are almost always forfeited on departure, with no leverage to negotiate afterward, so it has to be addressed before signing.

**Stock options** split into ISOs (employees only, better tax treatment) and NSOs. The load-bearing detail is the post-termination exercise window: historically just 90 days to decide whether to pay to exercise (plus possible AMT) or forfeit vested equity. A 90-day window with no early-exercise option, at a private company with no clear exit timeline, is the commonest way vested equity gets lost. Ask whether the grant is an ISO or NSO, the exact exercise window, and the most recent 409A price.

**ESPP** (employee stock purchase plan) lets you buy stock through payroll deduction at around a 15% discount, often with a lookback to the lower price. Given the built-in discount, it is close to free money and worth enrolling in even minimally.

**Private-company equity** is where face-value math misleads. The 409A valuation that sets the tax price is deliberately conservative and goes stale between financings. The bigger issue is the liquidation-preference stack: preferred investors are paid back before common stockholders, which is where employees sit, so a headline exit valuation can still leave common stock worth little. Discount illiquid private equity heavily against a public company's liquid shares. Ask what has been raised and on what preference terms, and treat an early-stage grant as a high-variance, low-expected-value instrument unless your savings cushion can support that exposure. A refusal to disclose the preference stack or total dilution is a warning sign.

**On an acquisition**, equity can be assumed, cashed out, or accelerated. Single-trigger acceleration vests on the deal closing; double-trigger (more protective) vests only if the deal closes and you're let go without cause within a window after. Ask which applies.

## The benefits

**Health insurance** means little as "we offer medical." It needs four numbers: the monthly premium and the employer/employee split, the deductible, the out-of-pocket maximum (2026 ACA cap: \$10,600 self-only / \$21,200 family), and the copay/coinsurance structure. Request the Summary of Benefits and Coverage — a standardized document — from each employer to compare like for like.

**HSA and FSA.** An HSA requires a high-deductible plan, is triple tax-advantaged, portable, and rolls over indefinitely; an FSA works with any plan but is largely use-it-or-lose-it. Many employers seed the HSA directly (\$500–\$1,000 self-only, \$1,000–\$2,000 family is common), which is real money on top of your own contributions and worth asking about.

**401(k).** Get the exact match formula — 100% up to 3% of pay, or 50% up to 6%, both land the employer at 3% — and the vesting schedule on the match (a cliff or a graded schedule; employee contributions are always yours immediately). A mega backdoor Roth is high-value where it exists, mostly at large tech and finance employers, and worth asking about since most plans don't support it.

**Life and disability.** Basic employer life insurance is typically 1x salary. Long-term disability replaces roughly half to two-thirds of salary after an elimination period. Disability is far more likely across a



career than death, and easy to overlook while focused on health and life coverage.

**PTO.** "Unlimited" deserves a skeptical eye: people on unlimited policies take about 16 days a year versus 14 on accrued plans, only a two-day difference, and unlimited PTO forfeits the cash-out value that accrued PTO has at termination in many states. Ask what departing employees take and whether unused accrued time pays out when you leave.

**Other things worth pricing.** Tuition reimbursement (often capped near \$5,250/year, the tax-free threshold), student-loan assistance, and — for anyone who needs it — visa or immigration sponsorship, whose real employer cost of \$10,000–\$25,000+ can outweigh most negotiable salary differences.

## The fine print

**At-will employment** is standard boilerplate in nearly every US offer; it is not itself a reason for alarm and not where to spend negotiating capital.

**Non-competes** are governed entirely by state law — there is no federal ban as of 2026. Several states (including California, Minnesota, Oklahoma, North Dakota, and DC) void them outright; others heavily restrict them, often below a salary threshold. If you're presented with one, scrutinize its duration, its geographic scope ("worldwide" is a red flag for a remote role), and how narrowly "competitor" is defined. Many companies will narrow the scope on request for an individual contributor.

**Non-solicit and non-disparagement** clauses survive even in states that ban non-competes; a non-disparagement clause in a severance agreement should carve out statements to government agencies.

**IP and invention-assignment agreements** assign work created "during employment" to the employer, language broad enough to sweep in side projects. Fill in the Prior Inventions Schedule to exclude anything you built beforehand; leaving it blank can be read as having nothing to exclude. Several states require a carve-out for inventions made entirely on your own time — confirm the notice is present.

**Contingencies** — background check, references, I-9, sometimes credential checks — usually resolve after you accept, occasionally after you've already resigned a prior job. If one fails, the offer can be pulled with no recourse. The practical rule: don't resign a current job or make an irreversible commitment until every contingency has formally cleared.

## What it's worth

A comparable total value adds up like this: **base + guaranteed cash + risk-adjusted bonus + equity expected value + monetized benefits.**

- **Bonus and commission** should never be counted at the headline target. Multiply the target by a realistic attainment rate — team-wide historical attainment, which a hiring manager can share, is a far better number than the OTE headline — and prorate a partial first year.

- **Equity.** Public RSUs are shares times current price, by vesting tranche. Private equity should be discounted by stage: an early-stage grant carries a much steeper discount than a late-stage, pre-IPO one, because the preference stack is larger relative to the company and liquidity is further off. Treat an early grant as high-variance.
- **Benefits** turn into dollars against your own paycheck. What you pay for health is a real cost that leaves your check every month, so it's subtracted; the money that comes back to you is added — the 401(k) match (if you contribute enough to capture it), an employer HSA contribution, and PTO valued at your daily rate (salary over about 260 working days) times the days. The employer's own share of the premium doesn't enter the math; it never touches your wallet. This is why two offers a few thousand dollars apart in salary can flip once the health premium is counted: a higher salary with a costlier plan can net less than a lower salary with fully paid coverage.
- **Comparing offers** with very different shapes — a high-base, low-equity role against a low-base, high-equity one at a risky startup — works best when you risk-adjust each one, normalize only the cash components for cost of living (equity isn't location-dependent), and look at a conservative case and an optimistic case side by side. An honest range beats one falsely precise number.

## Where Reimagine helps, and where Coach reasons with you

Reimagine prices the stable, factual parts of all this: the sourced market range (anchored, for a senior or officer role, on real officer pay from 990 or proxy filings rather than a generic range), the offer broken into its components, the monetized benefits, your first-year and steady-state total compensation stated in dollars (equity held out as a separate speculative line), and the side-by-side comparison. The parts that don't have a universal answer — how much to discount a specific private company's equity given its cap table, whether a non-compete matters given your state and your next move, whether visa sponsorship outweighs a lower base for you, how to weigh a risky high-equity offer against a stable high-base one given your actual savings cushion — depend on your situation. Those are a conversation with My Coach, which knows your profile and can reason through them with you.

## 12. Refining and Regenerating Your Results

*(Bridge Story is now lane-aware prose; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)*

This chapter explains how to use Reimagine the way it was designed to be used: iteratively, not perfectly the first time. If you only read one chapter from the second half of this guide, this is the one.

### Two kinds of changes you can make

Reimagine gives you two ways to change a result:

- **Tell Reimagine what to adjust, then regenerate.** Below every generated step there is a feedback box. Use it to flag factual misreads, missing context, or stylistic adjustments, then regenerate the step with your input folded in.
- **Update an earlier input and regenerate downstream.** Go back to one of the orientation steps (resume, assessment, values, etc.), change it, and regenerate the affected later steps.

Both are normal. Both preserve the rest of your work.

### The feedback box: factual corrections AND stylistic adjustments

Every generated step has a **Does this feel right?** box below the output. Click to open. You will see:

- A text field where you describe what to adjust. The microphone button is here too. You can speak instead of type.
- An **Update with my changes** button that regenerates the current step with your input folded in.
- A **Start fresh** button that clears your feedback and regenerates without it.

[screenshot: an open feedback box with a text field, microphone button, Update and Start fresh buttons]

The box is for two kinds of input.

#### Factual corrections

When Reimagine misreads your background, tell it. Examples:

- "My time at MoneyGram was internal strategy work, not consulting."
- "I led a team of 12, not 4."
- "You missed my P&L ownership at Acme."
- "I'm not an introvert at work, just selective."

These corrections do something important: **they carry forward**. When you submit a correction on one section, Reimagine saves it to your profile, and every later section you generate or regenerate reads from that list and honors it. You no longer need to make the same correction repeatedly across sections. If a section was already written before you made the correction, it shows a small note so you

can refresh it and bring it in line.

When you correct your Personal Brand, the correction joins your profile and applies to every later section you regenerate. The wrong assumption stops cascading.

## Stylistic adjustments

The feedback box also handles tone and emphasis requests:

- **Steer the direction.** "Show me more options in healthtech and fewer in financial services."
- **Adjust the tone.** "The opening doesn't sound like me. I'm more reserved than this version makes me seem."
- **Tighten or expand.** "The Why You Fit bullets are too long. Tighter, please."
- **Add missing information.** "I also led a 30-person team during the COVID restructure that you missed."

Reimagine does better with feedback that describes what you want than with feedback about what you do not want. "Make it lead with my operations experience" produces better results than "It shouldn't lead with product." Both work; the first is sharper.

Both kinds of feedback — factual fixes and tone steers — are saved to your profile and carry forward to the sections you generate next. A section written before your feedback shows a note so you can refresh it and apply the change. If you want a different tone in another section, just say so there; the tone you want in your Bridge Story may not be the tone you want in your Go-to-Market outreach.

## When to use Start fresh

Use **Start fresh** if the current direction is wrong enough that refining it will not help. Examples: the wrong direction is shaping your Role Options, or the Bridge Story is built around a part of your background you do not want to lead with. A fresh generation lets Reimagine try a different angle.

Start fresh does not delete previously submitted corrections from your profile; those still apply to the new generation.

## Prefer the version you had before?

Each time you refresh or start fresh on your Personal Brand, Reimagine keeps the version just before it. A **Restore previous version** button appears on the Personal Brand screen so you can switch back with one click, and switch again if you change your mind. It keeps the most recent prior version, so you can always compare the two.

## When Reimagine writes around a phrase you asked for

Reimagine deliberately writes around a small set of phrasings: jargon-shaped labels, marketing-cadence slogans, claims that rank you against other people, and coaching-speak. The voice is the product, so the tool holds that line even on request.

If you submit a correction that asks for one of those phrasings, Reimagine flags it before saving the correction and gives you three choices:

- **Apply anyway.** Reimagine honors the intent behind your request and regenerates the section, though the exact phrase may not appear word for word.
- **Rephrase.** Reimagine suggests a way to keep your meaning without the wording it writes around.
- **Take it offline.** Skip the correction and edit the wording yourself once the section is generated. What you generate is yours to change.

If you choose Apply anyway, the section shows an honest note so nothing is hidden from you: it tells you that you asked for that phrase and that Reimagine writes around it by design, then regenerates aiming at your intent.

When you correct a section that sits downstream of your foundation (your Bridge Story, your LinkedIn copy, and the like), you may also see a short, optional prompt asking whether you want to check the earlier section it came from. It is a reminder, not a step you have to take: if the same wording you just corrected also lives upstream, this is a one-click way to go look. Skip it and nothing changes.

## How to update an earlier input and regenerate

Sometimes the issue lives in an earlier input, not the current step. Some examples:

- You forgot to mention a major project on your resume.
- Your assessment did not capture something important and you want to add a note.
- You realize you should have included a passion you left out.
- Your work preference changed mid-journey.
- Your reputation answers were thinner than they should have been.

Here is how to handle that.

When you change an input after your Personal Brand is built, Reimagine reminds you: as you leave the input screen, a short prompt notes that the change will not show up until you refresh your Personal Brand, and offers to do it right then. Refreshing is safe, since your current version is saved and you can restore it if you prefer it. (This reminder appears only after your Personal Brand exists, so it never interrupts your first pass through orientation.)

### Step 1: Navigate back

The left sidebar shows every step in the journey. Click any completed step to return to it. Your inputs and outputs are preserved as you navigate.

[screenshot: the sidebar with completed steps showing checkmarks]

### Step 2: Update the input

Edit the field. Replace the resume file. Paste new text. Add a values entry. Whatever needs to change.

### Step 3: Regenerate the affected steps

When you regenerate a step (with **Update with my changes** or **Start fresh**), Reimagine applies your change to that step. The later steps you already built stay exactly as they were. None of your downstream work is wiped.

What changes is that the affected later steps now show a yellow staleness indicator, because they were written from the earlier version of the step you just changed. The indicator flags that the upstream moved and offers an **Update this section** button. You decide which later steps are worth refreshing and which are fine as they are.

The indicator comes in three forms, depending on what changed:

- A quiet note that the section was built from an earlier version, shown when an upstream step was regenerated.
- A note that names the specific section that changed, so you know where the update would come from.
- When the change came from a correction, a note that quotes your correction and counts how many times the old wording still appears in this section, so you can see exactly what a refresh would bring into line.

When you refresh a flagged step, it regenerates with your correction applied and the out-of-date upstream content left out of its context, so the new version reflects what is true now instead of re-inheriting the old wording. If you skip the refresh, the step stays as it is.

For most input edits that means a short, optional cascade: change your resume, regenerate Personal Brand, then refresh Role Options and any later steps you want to bring in line. Steps you do not plan to revisit can be left as they are until you need them.

One note for older saved profiles: the migration banner at the top of Personal Brand refreshes your Personal Brand in the current format. Like any upstream change, that flags the later steps so you can refresh them; it does not erase them.

## A practical example

Say you finished your Personal Brand and realized you forgot to mention that you led the post-merger integration at your last company, a large project that is central to who you are professionally.

You would:

- Click **Your Resume** in the sidebar to return to that screen.
- Update the resume text to include the merger integration with its outcomes and numbers.
- Click forward to **Personal Brand** in the sidebar.
- Open the feedback box, click **Start fresh**, and regenerate the Personal Brand.

The Personal Brand re-runs its two-stage build (a deep read of your inputs, then the synthesis) against your updated inputs. By the time it finishes, the merger integration will be in the foundation.

You can stop regenerating wherever the changes no longer matter. If your edit only affected the early phases and the rest of your journey was already aligned, you do not need to redo it all.

## Exploring a different direction after choosing your focus

You built a Focus Playbook for one role in Phase 2. Now you are curious what the journey would look like for a different option. Each direction you explore becomes its own Focus Playbook, saved alongside the others, so you keep everything you have already built.

- Use **Explore another direction** from the role options, or click **Career Paths** (Phase 2) in the sidebar.
- Choose a different role, or name a new direction in the input box. Reimagine builds a fresh **Focus Playbook** for it.
- Inside that playbook, build the sections you want (The Role, your Bridge Story, and the rest), and refine or regenerate any of them with its feedback box.

**My Playbooks** holds every Focus Playbook you build, and you can flip between directions without regenerating them. Your Phase 1 work (your Personal Brand) stays intact throughout, since only the per-role sections depend on the direction you picked.

## A reminder on what regeneration costs

Each regeneration produces a fresh version. There is no cost to you in money. The only cost is time. Most steps take three to four minutes; the Go-to-Market and Income Now steps take longer because they include live web research.

Refine and regenerate freely. The tool gets better with that feedback, and so does your output.

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*Next: Saving and Sharing Your Work →*

# 13. Saving and Sharing Your Work

*(Bridge Story structure updated 2026-05-19; see 07-tell-your-story.md for the current model.)*

This chapter covers how Reimagine saves your progress, how your work syncs across devices, and how to take your finished strategy with you.

## How saving works

When you are signed in, Reimagine saves your progress to your account automatically as you go. Your inputs, your outputs, the direction you picked, the list of roles you have explored, and any corrections you have submitted are all saved against your email and synced to your devices.

Your Focus Playbook sections are saved to your account alongside your inputs. You can build several playbooks across different roles simultaneously — each is saved separately and accessible from **My Playbooks** in the sidebar. On the My Playbooks dashboard, click a playbook's title to rename it, so a saved role reads the way you think of it. The PDF gives you a portable copy you can share or keep alongside your offline notes.

Three things worth knowing.

**Cross-device by default.** Sign in from a laptop, finish on a phone, pick up next week from a different computer. Your work travels with you as long as you sign in.

**Your data is stored on Career Club's database.** When you sign in, your work is saved to a database the team maintains, keyed to your email. The only parties that see your inputs are Anthropic's Claude service (which generates each section) and Career Club's own database (which holds your progress).

**Local fallback for users who decline sign-in.** If you reach the welcome screen and dismiss the sign-in prompt, Reimagine still works using browser-local storage. You can complete the full journey without an account. The trade-off is that you cannot move between devices, and clearing browser data clears your work. Sign-in is the safer mode for anyone using Reimagine seriously.

## Save a Focus Playbook as PDF

The Focus Playbook (Chapter 6) is where Reimagine builds everything for one role. Your work is saved to your Reimagine account and available on any device you sign in from, but the PDF gives you a portable copy you can share, send to a coach, or keep alongside your offline notes.

**Where the button is.** Once you have generated at least one section past The Role, a footer bar appears at the bottom of the Focus Playbook with a **Save Playbook as PDF** button. It stays in view as you scroll, so it is there the moment you decide a playbook is worth keeping.

**What it produces.** Clicking it assembles every section you have generated for this role (The Role, Bridge Story, and whatever else you built) into a single clean document and opens your browser's print dialog. Choose "Save as PDF" as the destination. The result is formatted for paper, with each section on its own page and Reimagine branding, so it reads well when you send it to a coach, a mentor, or someone you would like to refer you.



**Why save as PDF.** Your playbooks are saved to your account and you can switch between them in My Playbooks without losing work. The PDF is for moments when you want a portable copy: sending to a coach or mentor, reading on a device where you're not signed in, or keeping an annotated reference alongside your offline notes.

## Continuing where you left off

Sign in from any device. You land on the last step you were on, with all your previous inputs and outputs in place.

You can also click any completed step in the left sidebar to jump there.

## Snapshots and exports

Reimagine produces several artifacts you can take with you.

### Download all outputs as one markdown file

On the Complete screen, click **Download All Outputs as Markdown**. The file contains every generated section in one document, with clear headings between phases. Open it in any text editor, paste into a document, or convert it to PDF.

### The one-page PDF

The most portable summary of your work is the one-page PDF. It is generated from your final outputs and includes your personal brand, your value proposition, your bridge story, and your target direction in a clean printable format.

You can download it from two places on the Complete screen: the banner at the top, and the Your Deliverables section near the bottom.

Use it to share your story with a recruiter, a coach, or someone in your network you would like to refer you. It is designed to be readable in 60 seconds.

A creative use worth trying: upload the PDF into **Notebook LM** (Google's free notebook tool) and use the Audio Summary feature to generate a short podcast-style episode about you. Hearing two hosts talk about your background hits you differently than reading the same content on paper. Chapter 10 has the full setup.

### The target company list as a CSV

In Phase 4 (Find Your Market), Reimagine shows a callout with a **Download CSV** button right after your target company list. Click it and the entire list downloads as a spreadsheet. The columns include: Company, What they do, Industry, Size, HQ, Why it fits, Growth signal, Contact, and Email. The filename is keyed to your name, the role you are pursuing, and the date.

This is the most actionable artifact Reimagine produces. Open it in Excel, Google Sheets, or Numbers, and you have a working outreach tracker. Add columns as you go: when you reached out, what you heard back, the next step. Filter, sort, and share. Many users keep a live working copy that evolves as their search progresses and a separate clean copy of the original Reimagine output for reference.

## Copying individual sections

Every output section in Reimagine has a **Copy All** button at the top right of the panel. Click it to copy the full content of that section to your clipboard. The copy is clean plain text: the markdown formatting symbols (\*\*, #, -) are stripped so the result pastes cleanly into email, LinkedIn DMs, or any other context where you do not want raw markdown.

Use Copy All to move text into:

- A document where you are drafting cover letters or LinkedIn posts.
- An email to a coach or mentor.
- Your own notes app for reference during interviews.

The Copy All works for all generated sections, including the Bridge Story, the Go-to-Market plan, the LinkedIn copy, the playbook, and the Income Now plan.

## Start over from scratch

If you want to redo your entire journey, the **Start Fresh** option in the top-right header permanently deletes your profile, outputs, and chat history. You can sign back in with the same email and start over from the Welcome screen.

Use this when:

- Your initial inputs were wrong and you want a clean slate.
- You want to redo the journey with a different framing of your story.
- You no longer want your data in Reimagine.

Start Fresh is not the same as Sign Out. Sign Out keeps your profile and signs you back in next time. Start Fresh removes everything from Reimagine's servers (your profile, outputs, marked picks, chosen direction, chat history, and active sessions) and signs you out.

When you click Start Fresh, a browser dialog asks you to confirm. After you confirm, the page reloads to the Welcome screen, signed out. If you want to come back, sign in with the same email and you'll receive a fresh magic link to start over.

If you are signed in and the Welcome screen shows a "Continue Where I Left Off" panel because you have work in progress, a smaller "Or start fresh" link appears below the continue button as a quieter second surface.

## What to do if your work disappears

If you return to Reimagine and your session is gone, two things to check:

- **Are you signed in?** Click the welcome screen and enter your email. The sign-in link arrives in your inbox. Click it and your work reappears.

- **Are you using the same email you signed up with?** Your account is keyed to your email; signing in with a different address creates a fresh account.

If you used Reimagine before the sign-in feature shipped and declined the migration prompt, your work was browser-local. Look in the same browser on the same device. If you cleared browser data since then, the local progress is gone.

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*Next: [FAQ and Troubleshooting](#) →*

# 14. FAQ and Troubleshooting

## Getting started

**How long does this take?** The intake takes about 20 to 30 minutes. The full journey, including reading each output and refining where you want to, usually takes a few hours spread over multiple sessions. The full journey is meant to be paced across multiple sessions.

**Do I need to sign in?** Yes, by email. The welcome screen asks for your email and sends a magic-link to your inbox. (If you are new to Reimagine, it also asks for your first and last name on a second step.) Click the link and you are in. No password. Your sign-in lasts 30 days and refreshes each time you open the tool, so active users almost never see the sign-in screen again. Signing in is what makes your work follow you across devices.

**How long does sign-in last?** 30 days, but the clock resets every time you use Reimagine. If you open it once a week, you essentially never need to sign in again. If you go a full month without opening it, you sign in once and you are back where you left off. Your account and your work are preserved regardless; only the session times out.

**Is there a cost?** No, not today. Reimagine is in active beta and free to use.

**Do I have to take an assessment to use it?** No, but the recommendations will be more abstract without one. If you do not have one, the free Affintus assessment takes 15 minutes and gives Reimagine the data layer that makes everything more personal. The link is on the welcome screen and on the Assessment input screen.

## Inputs

**Can I use more than one assessment?** Yes, with a small workaround. Paste the results of each assessment sequentially into the text field on the Assessment screen with a divider line between each (=== CliftonStrengths === then results, then === Hogan === then results). Reimagine will read all of it.

**Should my assessment be recent?** Yes. We recommend assessments be no more than three years old. People change, and old data may not reflect how you operate today.

**Do I need to type everything?** No. Most text fields have a microphone button. Tap it and talk. Reimagine listens and writes what you say into the field.

**My resume is old. Should I update it before I start?** If you have time, yes. Especially adding numbers to your biggest accomplishments. If you do not, upload what you have. Reimagine will work with it and flag where to add quantification.

**What file formats does Reimagine accept?** For your resume and your assessment: PDF, Word (.docx), and plain text (.txt). For loading a saved profile: JSON (the file Reimagine itself produced when you exported).

## Saving and your data

**Where is my data stored?** Once you sign in, your work is stored in a Career Club database, keyed to your email, and synced to your devices. Before you sign in, work is in browser local storage as a fallback.

**Will Career Club share my data?** No. Your inputs and outputs are not shared with third parties. The only places your information travels are to Anthropic's Claude service (which generates each section of your strategy) and Career Club's own database (which holds your progress against your email).

**What if I clear my browser cache?** Once you are signed in, clearing cache does not affect your work. Sign in again on any device and your progress is there. If you declined the sign-in option and were using browser-local storage, clearing cache does clear your work.

**Can I move my work to another device?** Yes, automatically. Sign in from the new device with the same email and your full session is there. No file export needed.

**Can I have more than one Reimagine direction in flight at a time?** Not directly. Reimagine holds one active session per account. To explore two different directions in parallel, finish one, download the markdown of all outputs as a snapshot, then come back to the Decision step and pick a different option to generate downstream artifacts for the second direction. Chapter 12 covers the mechanics.

**Why is there only one playbook when I built the same role twice (or uploaded the same job description twice)?** Reimagine de-duplicates. If you pick the same role from Career Paths twice, or upload the same job description twice, Reimagine quietly re-links you to the existing playbook instead of creating a second copy. Your work is not lost; you land back in the same record, right where you left it. If you want a clean start on that role or job description, delete the existing playbook from My Playbooks first, then build it again.

## Inside the journey

**A generation is taking a long time. Is something wrong?** Most steps take three to four minutes. The Go-to-Market step (Phase 4) and the Income Now step include live web research and can take four to five minutes. Add an Opportunity is the exception: the page loads instantly and each of the four sections takes about 30 seconds to build on demand. If a step is taking longer than five minutes, refresh the page and try again.

**The output looks like it cut off.** Refresh the page and regenerate the step. If it happens again on the same step, use the refine box to ask for a shorter response and try again.

**I got an error message. What should I do?** Refresh the page. Your work is saved. Most errors are transient. Usually a network blip or a momentary issue with the language model. If the error persists for the same step, try refining with simpler input ("regenerate without the third option," for example) and try again.

**The output is in the wrong tone or doesn't sound like me.** Use the feedback box. Describe how you want it to sound. Example: "I'm more reserved than this version. Tighter sentences, less storytelling." Then click **Update with my changes**.

**Reimagine read my background wrong.** Tell it in the feedback box. Example: "My time at MoneyGram was internal strategy work, not consulting." Click **Update with my changes**. Factual

corrections persist across the whole session, so the correction propagates to every later section that depends on it.

**I refreshed my Personal Brand and liked the previous version better.** Reimagine keeps the version you had just before your last refresh or Start fresh. Click **Restore previous version** on the Personal Brand screen to bring it back. It is a one-click switch, and you can switch again if you change your mind, so you can compare the two. It keeps the most recent prior version.

**I edited an input, but my Personal Brand looks the same.** Your Personal Brand does not rebuild on its own when you change an input (your resume, values, reputation, assessment, and so on). When you leave a changed input, Reimagine reminds you and offers to update it right then; you can also refresh it any time from the Personal Brand screen. Refreshing is safe: your current version is saved, so you can restore it if you prefer it.

**What does the Bridge Story look like?** It is a single tell-me-about-yourself answer written in your voice and calibrated to the direction you picked. It opens with the strongest human anchor in your inputs (a passion, a craft you trained in, a formative experience, or an assessment finding), connects that to one accomplishment that carries the theme, and closes on why your next move is the natural next step. When your profile holds a second strong opening, Reimagine adds a short italic coaching note below the story. Chapter 7 covers the model in full.

**My Bridge Story is out of date after I changed my Orientation.** If you change your reputation, values, passions, assessment, or Your Story after generating, regenerate the Bridge Story so it reflects what is now true. Open the feedback box below the story and click **Start fresh** (or **Update with my changes** if you also have a specific note). Reimagine rebuilds from your current inputs; your saved story is replaced only when you regenerate it.

**The Bridge Story or LinkedIn copy uses words I would never say.** Open the feedback box below the section and tell Reimagine what to change, then regenerate. Examples: "Lead with my sustainability work instead," or "Don't use the word 'leverage,' I would not say that." The same feedback box works for the Bridge Story, LinkedIn copy, and every other section. Factual corrections save to your profile and carry into later sections; wording requests apply to the section you make them on.

**I want to explore a different direction or role after I picked one.** Use **Explore another direction** to return to the three directions, or pick a different role in the Lane Option view. Any role you have opened before also appears under **Roles You've Explored** in the sidebar with a Re-explore action. Switching roles regenerates that role's Focus Playbook fresh; if the current playbook has unsaved work, Reimagine offers to save it as a PDF first. Chapter 6 covers this in detail.

**I want different options, or options in a direction we missed.** On the Lane Option view, open **Tell us where else to look** and name a domain or direction we missed, or tell Reimagine what did not fit. Examples: "You missed affordable housing." "Consider education." "Remove consulting roles." "These skew too senior." It re-runs with your input weighted, without repeating the ones you have seen.

## Output and deliverables

**How do I save the final results?** Four ways:

- Download the one-page PDF from the Results screen. Designed for sharing with a recruiter, coach, or contact.
- Download the target company list as a CSV from the **Download CSV** button in Phase 4. This is the most useful artifact for tracking outreach over time.
- Download all outputs as one markdown file from the Results screen. The complete record of every generated section.
- Click **Copy All** on any section to copy that section's text to your clipboard. The output strips markdown symbols so the paste is clean.

**Can I print the full output?** Yes. Press Ctrl+P on Windows or Cmd+P on Mac from the section you want to print. Reimagine produces a clean printout of that section: the full content, paper-friendly type, no sidebar or buttons. From the print dialog you can save it as a PDF or send it to a printer. If you would rather paste into a document first, use **Copy All** at the top of the section. Both paths work, so pick whichever fits how you want to use the output. The one-page PDF on the Complete screen is also printable.

**Where do I share feedback about Reimagine itself?** There is a short feedback survey on the **Complete** screen at the end of the journey. Otherwise, email Bob at [bob@career.club](mailto:bob@career.club).

## When something stays broken

If a step keeps failing or the output is not making sense after multiple refines:

- Refresh the page. Your work is saved.
- Try again with a slightly different input.
- Sign out and sign back in. A clean session sometimes resolves transient state issues.
- If none of that works, email [bob@career.club](mailto:bob@career.club) and describe what was happening. Beta feedback is what shapes the next build.

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*Next: Glossary →*

# 15. Glossary

These are the terms you will encounter inside Reimagine, in this guide, or in the methodology behind the tool.

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**Affintus.** A free 15-minute professional assessment Reimagine recommends if you do not already have one. It produces results you can paste into the Assessment input screen.

**Bridge Story.** Your answer to "tell me about yourself": a single flowing answer in your voice, calibrated to the direction you picked. It opens with the strongest human anchor in your inputs, connects that to one accomplishment that carries the theme, and closes on why your next move is the natural next step. When your profile holds a second strong opening, Reimagine adds a short coaching note below it. Saved as a persistent asset that feeds the later steps needing a "tell me about yourself." It is the section after The Role in the Focus Playbook. See Chapter 7 for the model and how to use it.

**Brand Synthesis.** Retired in 2026-05-20. The Phase 1 output is now Personal Brand, a single flowing prose synthesis that includes the through-line, evidence triangulation, a transfer reading, and dimensional fit across function, industry, position, scale, pace, and mission.

**Career Club.** The company that builds Reimagine. Founded by Bob Goodwin.

**Convictions, Clarity, Confidence, Contagious (the 4 C's).** The internal arc of the Reimagine experience. Convictions are what is true about you. Clarity follows from convictions and lets you see options clearly. Confidence comes from evidence. Contagious is the natural result. When you believe, others do too. The framework is part of the methodology, not exposed in the tool's outputs.

**Deep Dive.** Retired in v1. The old compare-three-options step no longer exists. Its analysis (what the role is, why you fit, what to consider) is now The Role, the first section of the Focus Playbook for a single role.

**Demo mode.** A guided walkthrough using a fictional executive (Sarah Chen). It is being rebuilt for the new flow and is temporarily unavailable; `?demo=true` shows a short notice rather than the old tour.

**Dimensional read (how Reimagine reads career fit).** When Reimagine writes your Personal Brand, it assesses your fit across six dimensions internally and emits a reading on each. The prose does not name these dimensions as labels (that is internal scaffolding), but if you are curious how the analysis is structured, here it is:

- **Function.** Your core skill or expertise. What you do for a living.
- **Industry.** The sector you work in or know well: healthcare, tech, finance, nonprofit, and so on. Industries have their own language, problems, and operating rhythms.
- **Position in the value chain.** Where you sit relative to the customer or end user: inside the operating company, on the vendor or supplier side, in consulting or advisory work, on the regulator side. The same industry looks different from different positions.
- **Scale.** The size of the organization or the P&L you have managed. Scale changes the day-to-day experience of the work.



- **Pace.** How fast the work moves: startup chaos, steady enterprise rhythm, regulated-industry cycles. People differ in which pace they thrive in.
- **Mission.** What the organization exists to do in the world: profit maximization, social impact, public health, education, innovation. Mission is the "why" that energizes or drains people over time.

The Personal Brand prose names what is settled about your fit and what is open. Settled means your track record points clearly; open means the next move has real choices. The dimensions are how Reimagine thinks; the settled / open framing is what the prose writes.

**Direction (lane).** One of the three choices on the Lane Selection screen in Phase 2: Familiar Ground, Industry Insider, or Work That Matters. You pick one direction at a time; Reimagine generates role options for that direction only.

**Focus Playbook.** The single assembled page Reimagine builds for one role. It opens with an orientation card ("How to use your playbook") and holds seven numbered sections grouped into four named groups, plus Income Now as a bonus stripe. Group 1, Understand the role: The Role. Group 2, Build your story: Your Bridge Story, Industry Background. Group 3, Prepare for the conversation: Interview Prep (with STAR stories woven in). Group 4, Carry it into the market: Resume Refresh, LinkedIn Remix, Go-to-Market. The Role generates immediately; the rest generate on demand.

**Familiar Ground.** One of the three directions on the Lane Selection screen. Same kind of work in a new seat: a bigger scope, the same role elsewhere, or your function in a new industry. Where your existing track record speaks most directly.

**Go-to-Market Strategy.** Section 7 of the Focus Playbook, in Group 4 (Carry it into the market). A target company list, a hiring executive profile, a personalized outreach template, and a LinkedIn signal tweak, built around the role you are exploring. It runs live web research, so it is the most expensive section to generate and sits late in the arc on purpose.

**Golden Thread.** The single consistent theme that runs through your accomplishments, your wiring, and your reputation. Surfaced as the lead sentence of your Personal Brand.

**Key Accomplishments.** The section of your resume that holds your strongest career achievements, reframed as money made, money saved, or risk mitigated with numbers attached. The Resume Refresh section of your Focus Playbook generates these for you. In *Making Your Own Weather*, this same idea is called your "Greatest Hits"; Reimagine uses Key Accomplishments as the user-facing label because it reads cleanly as a resume section header. Career Highlights, Career Milestones, or Selected Achievements work equally well if you prefer one of those.

**Ikigai.** The Japanese concept used in the *Work That Matters* path. The intersection of what you love, what you are good at, what the world needs, and what you can be paid for.

**Income Now.** Bonus stripe at the bottom of the Focus Playbook, not numbered alongside the seven core sections. A consulting and fractional income plan for generating revenue while you search for your next role. Optional; skip if income continuity is not a concern for you right now.

**Industry Insider.** One of the three directions on the Lane Selection screen. The wider set of organizations around your industry: clients, vendors, consultants, regulators, adjacent players. Where your insider knowledge is a competitive advantage.

**KEEL principles.** The foundation of the *Making Your Own Weather* methodology. Mentioned in marketing materials but not exposed inside the tool's outputs.

**Local storage.** The browser feature Reimagine uses to save your work on your device. Same browser, same device required to retrieve it.

**Made money / Saved money / Mitigated risk.** The three business imperatives Reimagine uses to translate your accomplishments. Every accomplishment in your output should be framed as one of these three with a number attached.

**Making Your Own Weather (MYOW).** The book by Bob Goodwin that the Reimagine methodology is built on.

**One-Pager.** A short downloadable PDF summary produced from legacy completed journeys. In v1 the primary takeaway artifacts are the Focus Playbook PDF and the Opportunity Playbook PDF (see Save Playbook as PDF).

**Orientation.** Phase 0 of the journey. The intake phase where you provide your inputs: location, resume, assessment, values, passions, and reputation.

**Path.** Older term for a Direction (lane). The three are Familiar Ground, Industry Insider, and Work That Matters, chosen one at a time on the Lane Selection screen.

**Personal Brand.** The single Phase 1 output. A flowing 600-800 word prose synthesis of who you are at work: a lead sentence stating the through-line, two or three paragraphs triangulating evidence across your career, your assessment, your reputation, and your story, a transfer paragraph naming forward contexts, dimensional fit across function/industry/position/scale/pace/mission with bolded inline keywords, and a closing italic invitation to confirm or redirect the framing.

**Playbook.** The Focus Playbook, the assembled page Reimagine builds for one role. Seven sections across four groups, plus Income Now as an optional bonus. The section formerly called Lingo & Playbook is now Industry Background.

**Industry Background.** The Focus Playbook section that gives you the vocabulary, the frameworks, and the people who shape the space you are entering. Section 3, in the Build your story group. Formerly called Lingo & Playbook, then The Lingo.

**Lingo & Playbook.** Retired 2026-05-21. See Industry Background.

**The Lingo.** Renamed 2026-05-23 to Industry Background. See Industry Background.

**Quick Takeaway.** A short summary at the top of some generated sections. Three to five sentences that give you the essentials without expanding the full output. Retired from the Personal Brand output in 2026-05-20 (the lead sentence now carries that role) and from Role Options in 2026-05-27 (the umbrella paragraph at the top of each lane now carries that role). Still used in Go-to-Market and in The Role focus card.

**Refine box.** The "Does this feel right?" box below every generated output. Where you tell Reimagine what to adjust before regenerating.

**Reputation.** The final input in the Orientation phase. External data about how others see you, gathered through four short prompts.

**Resume Refresh.** A section of the Focus Playbook. Your resume rewritten so the strongest evidence for the role you are exploring is visible in the first seven seconds, downloadable as a Word document.

**Sarah Chen.** The fictional executive used in Reimagine's demo mode. A VP of Talent Acquisition in healthcare with 15 years of experience.

**STAR (Situation, Thinking, Action, Result).** The interview story framework Reimagine uses inside Interview Prep, where each story sits next to the question it best answers. The T stands for *Thinking*, not Tasks. Because the most important part of any interview story is how you thought through the problem. **TMAY.** "Tell me about yourself." The interview question the Bridge Story is built to answer, as a single answer in your voice you can say in about 30 seconds.

**Value Proposition.** Retired as a separately-labeled section in 2026-05-20. The capability-plus-proof entries are now woven into the Personal Brand prose, with specific accomplishments and numbers cited inline as proof of the through-line.

**Wide View.** Retired in v1. The old single screen showing all three paths at once is replaced by the Put It to Work screen, Lane Selection, and the Lane Option view (one direction at a time).

**Lane Option view.** The screen that lists role options for the one direction you picked. Each option can be opened into a full Focus Playbook. Includes a "see more options" feedback box and honest handling when only a few strong options exist.

**My Playbooks.** The sidebar section listing every Focus Playbook you have built. Open any of them to pick up where you left off; your sections, your inputs, and your refinements are all there.

**Save Playbook as PDF.** The button in the Focus Playbook footer that assembles every generated section for the current role into one printable document. Useful for sharing with a coach or mentor, reading on a device where you're not signed in, or keeping an annotated reference alongside your offline notes.

**Put It to Work.** The first screen in Phase 2. Two cards: **Career Paths** leads to picking a direction and exploring roles; **Add an Opportunity** takes a pasted job description and builds a playbook for that exact role. Renamed 2026-05-27 from "Two Doors / Choose Your Path"; the sidebar entry under Phase 2 routes here from anywhere in the app.

**Wiring & Compass.** Fully retired. It became an internal analytical pass when it stopped being a separate user-visible step in 2026-05-20, and as of 2026-06-19 that pass is gone too. How you are wired, where you thrive, and what lights you up are now read directly from your assessment, values, and accomplishments inside the Personal Brand build.

**Work That Matters.** One of the three directions on the Lane Selection screen. The Ikigai direction, for people ready for more meaning in their work or at a stage where legacy matters more than maximizing comp.